

FILE FULL TIẾNG ANH SÁCH SONG NGỮ

PASSAGE 1

- a. Lifelong learning is especially relevant in today's changing world.
 - b. Whatever choice you make, remember to keep on learning new knowledge and skills.
 - c. Remember that learning is a lifelong journey, so enjoy every moment of it.
 - d. In a few weeks' time, you'll complete your secondary education.
 - e. Some of you may have already made plans for continuing your studies at university or vocational school, while others may wish to start working right away.
 - f. In fact, learning does not stop after graduation because it is a lifelong process.
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PASSAGE 2

- a. Besides, doing chores together can actually be fun and it makes the work go faster.
 - b. Dear Mike, I hope you are well! I've been thinking about why it's important for children to help with housework.
 - c. It's a good way for families to spend time together and learn new skills.
 - d. Firstly, it teaches us responsibility and how to take care of our own things.
 - e. Also, when we help our parents, it shows them respect and gratitude for all they do for us.
 - f. Best wishes.
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PASSAGE 3

- a. Good morning, everyone. As part of our school cultural programme, we need to

plan a field trip to a heritage site in Viet Nam. So, where would you like to go?

b. What's a mixed heritage site?

c. I'd recommend Trang An Scenic Landscape Complex. It's the only place in Southeast Asia to be recognised as a mixed heritage site by UNESCO.

d. Do you have any suggestions for us, Ms Hoa?

e. That sounds interesting, but if we want to learn about cultural values of the past.

f. It's a site that has both natural and cultural importance. For example, you can go on a boat trip there to enjoy the beautiful landscape. Or you can visit the old temples and monuments to learn about Vietnamese history.

PASSAGE 4

a. Best wishes.

b. First of all, self-study gives learners more freedom. They decide what they should study and how to learn depending on their abilities.

c. Dear Lucy, I hope you are well. I am thinking about the advantages of self-study - learning at home without a teacher.

d. Secondly, they can make learners responsible. They set their learning goals and make study plans to achieve them.

e. Finally, it makes them more confident. Completing tasks and solving problems on their own boost learners' confidence.

PASSAGE 5

a. First, we should set up some food stalls offering traditional dishes from different cultures.

b. Let's discuss what activities to include.

c. That sounds fun! We can call them 'Taste the World'. We can also show visitors

how to cook these dishes.

d. I like your idea, but we don't have any cooking experience. We may need to involve professional cooks.

e. We've decided to organise a Cultural Diversity Day in our school.

PASSAGE 6

a. Last year, I gained valuable experience working part-time at a local computer repair centre, and I also spent six months as a tech support trainee at a major IT firm.

b. I am writing to apply for the IT support technician position advertised in the local newspaper on Tuesday 5th July.

c. I am very adaptable, reliable and excellent at multitasking, and I have strong communication skills and natural problem-solving abilities.

d. I have a bachelor's degree in IT from the University of Leeds, and I have recently completed a master's in IT management.

e. I have attached a copy of my CV to this letter for your review.

f. If you have any questions about me, please let me know. I look forward to hearing from you soon.

PASSAGE 7

a. Hi Miranda, How are things?

b. My parents are very strict and set hard rules.

c. I can't wait to hear from you. Write back soon.

d. Everything is great at school except I'm having problems with my parents at home.

e. I really need some advice. Most of the time we get along really well and I enjoy spending time with them.

f. Hope you are doing well.

PASSAGE 8

- a. Thank you for considering this request, and I appreciate your efforts in creating memorable experiences for our class.
 - b. With the end of the school year approaching, I wanted to inquire about any plans for a year-end party or celebration for our class.
 - c. If there are any plans or discussions underway for a year-end party, could you please provide some information regarding the date, time, location, and any arrangements that may be needed.
 - d. Additionally, if there's anything the students can contribute or assist with to make the event a success, please let us know.
 - e. It would be wonderful to have an opportunity to gather as a class and celebrate our achievements and the bonds we've formed throughout the year.
 - f. Many of us students are looking forward to commemorating the end of the academic year and spending some enjoyable time together before the break.
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PASSAGE 9

- a. I heard about this opportunity in a public announcement last Monday.
- b. I am interested in your community development projects because I really care about the life of people in the community and want to offer my services to you.
- c. I am writing to apply for a volunteer position at the local center for community development.
- d. Currently, all my Sunday afternoons are free, and I will be able to help at the center if I am chosen.
- e. I look forward to hearing from you.

f. I am always available for an interview on any weekday after 4.30 p.m. or at weekends.

PASSAGE 10

- a. For example, here in Viet Nam, we can enjoy Italian pizza or Japanese sushi, in addition to our traditional food.
 - b. On the other hand, Vietnamese specialties, such as pho and banh mi, are also gaining popularity worldwide.
 - c. Fast food chains and international restaurants have become popular, offering a wide range of dishes and more food choices to local people.
 - d. Moreover, some international dishes use local ingredients, which make them unique and more suitable to local tastes.
 - e. In short, you can explore the flavorful world of traditional Vietnamese food or enjoy dishes from other countries around the world in Viet Nam.
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PASSAGE 11

- a. Firstly, as a student, Francesca demonstrated a love of learning and the level of commitment necessary to succeed in college and beyond. I am happy to be able to provide this recommendation for such a deserving student.
- b. Please do not hesitate in contacting me with any questions that you may have, and let me know if I can provide any additional information in support of this deserving student. You may reach me at helenb@school.com.
- c. Dear Sir/Madam, I am writing this letter to recommend Francesca Stevens for the Linda Williams Scholarship. I was her Social Studies and History teacher and have closely followed her academic progress during the past three years.
- d. Secondly, Francesca has distinguished herself as an incredible young writer

through her work in my classes as well as in her creative and essay writing in English and Literature.

e. In addition to having firsthand knowledge of Francesca's academic commitment and talent, I feel certain that you will be just as impressed with Francesca as I am.

f. For example, as her academic record attests, Ms. Francesca has maintained an A grade average across the board during her study here at Fallow High School.

PASSAGE 12

a. Greetings from Vietnam! At the weekend, Paul and I went to one of the oldest cities in Vietnam called Hội An.

b. The next morning, we went to a sandy beach near the city and had a relaxing swim.

c. We first walked around the charming streets of the old town.

d. Our visit to Hội An was so wonderful that we did not want to leave.

e. In the afternoon, we visited a picturesque village called Trà Quế, where we took a cooking class and learned how to make some local dishes.

f. Dear Stacy,

PASSAGE 13

The exhibition here is based around large models showing how living creatures use their amazing skills in the wild. Dress up like a jungle creature to discover how they deal with a changing environment. Or help build a model of a giraffe – and even get one from the shop to take away!

PASSAGE 14

Dear students, We are excited to announce that our annual school fair will be celebrated on Friday, February 2nd, 2024. The fair will start at 9:00 AM and end at 4:00 PM.

There will be a variety of games, food stalls, and performances for everyone to enjoy. We encourage all students to participate and make this event a success.

Please note, should it rain on February 2nd, the fair will be postponed to the following Friday, February 9th, 2024.

PASSAGE 15

- a. Besides, doing chores together can actually be fun and it makes the work go faster.
 - b. Dear Mike, I hope you are well! I've been thinking about why it's important for children to help with housework.
 - c. It's a good way for families to spend time together and learn new skills.
 - d. Firstly, it teaches us responsibility and how to take care of our own things.
 - e. Also, when we help our parents, it shows them respect and gratitude for all they do for us.
 - f. Best wishes.
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PASSAGE 16

- a. In my opinion, you could definitely be a great interior designer.
- b. It's nice to hear from you. How is it going?
- c. Let me know what you decide to do. I think we should meet up over the holidays.
- d. I'm so happy that you're doing well and enjoying your new home in Canada.
- e. I'd be happy to give you some advice on your career.
- f. However, as an interior designer, you could have some really difficult clients who

don't know what they want or find it hard to keep up with the newest trends and popular styles.

PASSAGE 17

- a. I understand that ensuring the comfort and safety of students and staff is a priority for the school. I am writing to bring to your attention a concerning issue regarding the lack of air conditioning in classroom 12A4.
 - b. The absence of adequate cooling not only affects our concentration but also poses health risks, especially during warmer weather conditions.
 - c. As the temperatures continue to rise, it has become increasingly uncomfortable and difficult for both students and teachers to focus and perform effectively in the learning environment.
 - d. Thank you for your attention to this matter, and I look forward to a resolution soon.
 - e. Therefore, I kindly request your prompt attention to this matter. Implementing a solution, such as repairing the existing air conditioning system or providing temporary cooling measures, would greatly alleviate the discomfort experienced by everyone in the affected area.
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PASSAGE 18

- a. Furthermore, the proliferation of violent content on television can exacerbate societal issues related to crime and aggression.
- b. The impact of violence depicted in television programmes on social development is a subject of ongoing concern.
- c. First and foremost, exposure to high levels of violence on television can desensitise individuals, particularly the younger demographic, to aggressive behaviour and its consequences.

- d. In conclusion, the reduction of violence in television programmes is essential for fostering healthy social development.
- e. By reducing the portrayal of violence in TV programmes, society can mitigate these negative social repercussions and work towards a more harmonious and empathetic environment.
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PASSAGE 19

- a. Would it be possible to schedule a meeting sometime this week at your convenience.
- b. I hope this email finds you well.
- c. Please let me know a time that works best for you, and I will adjust my schedule accordingly.
- d. As we approach the final test, I would like to request a brief meeting to discuss any concerns or questions I may have regarding the test.
- e. Thank you for considering my request. I look forward to our meeting and appreciate your support.
- f. Your guidance throughout this course has been invaluable, and I believe that a discussion prior to the final test will help clarify any uncertainties I may have and ensure that I am adequately prepared.
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PASSAGE 20

Owning a franchise can be magical!

The expanding children's service market offers an excellent return on your investment and puts a little magic into your summer. Summer Magic Day Camps franchises provide door-to-door pick-up services for children ages 6-13 and a wide variety of activities in parks and other locations. No need to invest in expensive camp

facilities, as all activities are held off-premises. You can operate the business part-time and from home.

We provide all the know-how and direction needed for start-up and day-to-day operations. Very reasonable franchise fees.

PASSAGE 21

- a. I've been reflecting on why it's crucial for children to lend a hand with household chores.
 - b. I hope this email finds you well!
 - c. Firstly, it's a good way for families to bond and acquire new skills.
 - d. Last but not least, it instills responsibility and the importance of caring for our belongings.
 - e. Also, when we assist our parents, it demonstrates respect and gratitude for their efforts.
 - f. Besides, doing chores together can actually be fun and it makes the work go faster.
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PASSAGE 22

- a. Finally, those who have a part-time job can build more relationships for their careers in the future.
- b. Students will become more confident if they have opportunities to work together with different groups of people.
- c. To begin with, students can gain and develop important skills that may be useful in their future careers.
- d. Today, more and more students are doing part-time jobs while they are still studying at secondary school.

e. In addition, having a part-time job can provide students with more experience and then.

PASSAGE 23

- a. Firstly, it is more convenient for Vietnam to promote its culture and learn about other countries.
 - b. Secondly, this has created more educational opportunities for both Vietnamese and foreign students.
 - c. Viet Nam has gained three main benefits since it joined different international organizations.
 - d. Finally, joining these organizations has also helped Vietnam increase local and international tourism.
 - e. For example, various cultural exchanges help visitors know more about our country, and Vietnamese people have a better chance of experiencing different cultures.
 - f. Because Vietnam has become one of the most popular destinations, many foreign tourists are attracted by its scenic beauty.
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PASSAGE 24

- a. Personally, I think that you may be long-term friends with someone who is on the same wavelength as you.
- b. I think opposites do attract, but those different qualities that attracted you at first can annoy you later.
- c. On the whole, I don't agree with that opinion.
- d. I think people choose like-minded friends. That extends to physical appearance -

- if you have similar tastes, you may appreciate similar clothes and hairstyles.
- e. It is sometimes claimed that opposites attract when it comes to friendship.
-

PASSAGE 25

- a. Also, make sure to drink plenty of water and avoid sugary drinks.
- b. Hope you're all doing well! I just wanted to share some tips on staying healthy with you.
- c. Lastly, it's important to sleep around 8 hours each night. Take care of yourselves!
- d. Firstly, try to eat lots of fruits and veggies every day, they're super good for you.
- e. Moreover, getting active is important too – even a short walk or some fun dancing counts!
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PASSAGE 26

- a. However, refined sugar is not healthy and is added to many processed foods to make them taste better.
- b. Moreover, refined sugar has no nutritional value and therefore offers 'empty' calories.
- c. Humans have a natural sweet tooth and it can be difficult to control our sugar-eating habits.
- d. Obviously, naturally occurring sugar, for example in fruit, is considered healthy sugar.
- e. Surprisingly, this 'hidden' sugar can be found in many savory foods like bread, tins of vegetables, and sauces.
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PASSAGE 27

- a. What's more, we can reduce stress and feel better when reading books.
 - b. First of all, it provides us much information that we need to know about the things around us.
 - c. Everyone can receive a lot of advantages from reading books.
 - d. Besides, reading books also helps us concentrate on things.
 - e. The last but not least is that reading can improve our writing skills.
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PASSAGE 28

- a. Secondly, swimming is an excellent way to keep myself fit and healthy.
 - b. Among my favourite sports and hobbies, I like swimming the best for several reasons.
 - c. In addition, it helps promote our friendship and solidarity.
 - d. Firstly, I think playing in the water could bring great joy. It also helps reduce stress and I always feel refreshed and relaxed after swimming for about half an hour.
 - e. Also, it helps build up my muscle strength and prevent many heart and lung diseases.
 - f. Finally, besides being a great sport, swimming is also an important survival skill, because without knowing how to swim well, it could be dangerous if there is a flood, or simply if we want to play near bodies of water.
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PASSAGE 29

- a. For example, we should turn off lights and electronics when they are not in use.
- b. Overall, reducing energy consumption and investing in renewable energy sources are important solutions to the energy crisis.
- c. The first suggestion is that we should reduce our energy consumption.

- d. The climate crisis, which threatens both the global economy and the environment, is undoubtedly one of the most concerning issues of the twenty-first century.
 - e. Another useful suggestion would be to invest in renewable energy sources.
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PASSAGE 30

- a. Some fishermen break coral to try to catch rare fish.
 - b. Illegal hunting is one of the main environmental issues in the world today.
 - c. To conclude, illegal hunting can cause animals to go extinct and it can also cause damage to the environment.
 - d. Another problem caused by illegal hunting is that it can cause damage to coral reefs.
 - e. One problem caused by illegal hunting is that it can make some animals go extinct.
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PASSAGE 31

- a. Also, volunteering helps students connect with the community, making them aware of the needs around them.
 - b. Additionally, students develop such important skills as teamwork and communication ones while they volunteer.
 - c. Firstly, students who do voluntary work gain valuable real-world experience which can help in their future careers.
 - d. Finally, doing volunteer work can be a rewarding experience, as students feel good about helping others.
 - e. High school students benefit from doing voluntary work in many ways.
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PASSAGE 32

- a. Next, our guide, Trung, took us to Hanoi Botanical Garden for an escape from the crowded city.
 - b. Our first stop was one of the most popular tourist attractions in Hanoi, the Temple of Literature, which was Vietnam's first national university.
 - c. Hello fellow travellers! I just got back from a culture-packed day tour of Hanoi.
 - d. It was a great day and I highly recommend touring Hanoi with City Break!
 - e. Our final stop on the tour was the Old Quarter, a busy shopping area.
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PASSAGE 33

- a. It's true, we don't have much free time, but doing a few chores doesn't take long.
 - b. I think we should try to help our parents because it's not fair for them to do everything.
 - c. I'm sorry to hear that you're so busy with your studies and have too many chores to do.
 - d. Hi Jack, How are you?
 - e. Talk to you soon!
 - f. I am very busy with school and other activities too, but I still help around the house.
-

PASSAGE 34

- a. However, the introduction of foreign species can disrupt these balances, often leading to unforeseen consequences.

- b. To begin with, please remember ecological systems help maintain the diversity of life.
 - c. In response, laws that deter illegal activities such as releasing non-native species or overhunting have been implemented.
 - d. In conclusion, this effort is part of a broader movement to preserve our planet's ecological health.
 - e. For example, coral reefs, grasslands, and northern forests help protect a variety of species including the endangered ones.
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PASSAGE 35

- a. Best wishes.
 - b. First of all, self-study gives learners more freedom. They decide what they should study and how to learn depending on their abilities.
 - c. Dear Lucy, I hope you are well. I am thinking about the advantages of self-study - learning at home without a teacher.
 - d. Secondly, they can make learners responsible. They set their learning goals and make study plans to achieve them.
 - e. Finally, it makes them more confident. Completing tasks and solving problems on their own boost learners' confidence.
-

PASSAGE 37

- a. What's more, we can reduce stress and feel better when reading books.

- b. First of all, it provides us much information that we need to know about the things around us.
 - c. Everyone can receive a lot of advantages from reading books.
 - d. Besides, reading books also helps us concentrate on things.
 - e. The last but not least is that reading can improve our writing skills.
-

PASSAGE 38

- a. I heard about this opportunity in a public announcement last Monday.
 - b. I am interested in your community development projects because I really care about the life of people in the community and want to offer my services to you.
 - c. I am writing to apply for a volunteer position at the local center for community development.
 - d. Currently, all my Sunday afternoons are free, and I will be able to help at the center if I am chosen.
 - e. I look forward to hearing from you.
 - f. I am always available for an interview on any weekday after 4:30 p.m. or at weekends.
-

PASSAGE 39

- a. Firstly, by doing voluntary work people can contribute their enthusiasm and energy to the society, which also results in spending free time more usefully.
- b. Last but not least, voluntary work connects different people as it provides a chance for volunteers to meet up and establish new relationships.
- c. Besides, when doing voluntary tasks, volunteers can receive some significant skills.
- d. Volunteering is important for numerous reasons that benefit both the community

and the volunteers themselves.

e. To sum up, volunteers can not only give but also receive many useful experiences from voluntary activities.

f. They may learn how to socialize with others, or learn how to cooperate in a diverse team, or deal with problems in a logical way.

PASSAGE 40

City Golf Course encourages reservations. Only one reservation per call.

For weekdays, call one full day in advance. Call Wednesday between 5 and 8 p.m. for Saturday and Thursday between 5 and 8 p.m. for Sunday.

Anyone making reservations is expected to check in with the pro shop a quarter hour prior to tee time.

PASSAGE 41

a. In light of this restructuring, we will be contacting all employees individually to arrange a meeting with each of you to discuss your position and future plans.

b. Although we have yet to finalise the details of these changes, we can guarantee that there will be no redundancies and we will try to match your skills with the most appropriate job.

c. Dear colleagues, further to recent discussions with the management team, it has now been decided to restructure the company.

d. As you know, over the past two years the company has grown considerably but, along with higher turnover, there has also been increased employee turnover.

e. In fact, we expect these changes to offer more opportunities for you to utilise your skills more effectively and for personal development.

f. It is therefore obvious that we need to make some major changes in order to retain

our most valuable asset – our employees.

g. Yours sincerely,

PASSAGE 42

- a. Finally, would you mind telling me if there are native German-speaking teachers at your language centre?
 - b. First, could you please let me know whether there are German courses at your language centre?
 - c. Dear Sir or Madam, I am writing to ask for some information about the language courses at your language centre.
 - d. I look forward to hearing from you.
 - e. Yours faithfully,
 - f. Next, I would also like to know how long the course for beginners lasts and how often classes take place.
-

PASSAGE 43

- a. Next, it enables you to build better relationships with people because through frequent sports you can get to know a lot about others' personalities.
 - b. First, playing sports helps reduce stress and gives you more energy in your life.
 - c. In short, people should play sports regularly because it brings lots of advantages.
 - d. Lastly, it improves your health. When playing sports, the body is protected from different types of harmful bacteria and viruses.
 - e. Playing sports brings a lot of advantages.
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PASSAGE 44

- a. I am writing to inquire about the tour guide training courses offered by SGV Vocational School. I am very interested in exploring different cultures and would like to know more about the courses.
 - b. Dear Sir / Madam,
 - c. Secondly, I would appreciate it if you could inform me if SGV Vocational School offers any discounts for students who are financially disadvantaged. This would greatly assist me in planning for the cost of the training.
 - d. Lastly, I would like to enquire about the daily wage for the apprenticeships provided by SGV Vocational School. It would be great if you could provide me with more information about this opportunity.
 - e. Thank you for considering my request. I look forward to hearing from you soon.
Yours faithfully,
 - f. Firstly, I would like to ask if there is a test requirement to enroll in the tour guide training courses. As I do not have any previous qualifications in this field, I would like to know if there are any specific requirements for admission.
-

PASSAGE 45

- a. They may also learn about food safety, kitchen hygiene, and restaurant management if the course covers those topics.
- b. Additionally, students may hope to gain hands-on experience in cooking and receive feedback on their dishes from their instructor.
- c. Students can take a vocational course in cooking or culinary arts.
- d. They expect to learn various cooking techniques and recipes as well as gain a deeper understanding of the culinary arts.
- e. Overall, the goal of this course is likely to help students develop their skills and knowledge in the culinary field.

PASSAGE 46

- a. Additionally, traffic congestion makes commuting a hassle.
- b. First, the constant noise and pollution can be overwhelming at times.
- c. Dear Phillips, I hope this letter finds you well.
- d. Let's catch up soon and discuss more about city life. Best wishes.
- e. For example, in Hanoi where I live, during rush hours the streets are packed with cars, buses, and taxis, causing long delays and frustration for commuters.
- f. Living in a big city comes with its challenges.
- g. Finally, despite the convenience of amenities, the fast-paced lifestyle can lead to stress and exhaustion.

PASSAGE 47

- a. Dear Peter, I hope you are well! I have been thinking about why it is important for us to preserve our heritage and how to do it.
 - b. Some reasons and ways above are to help preserve and develop the heritage sites with cultural and natural values.
 - c. Firstly, learning about cultural heritage at school can help students understand the value of cultural heritage sites.
 - d. Besides, introducing cultural heritage to foreign visitors through tourism activities will make it more widely known to people around the world.
 - e. Also, promoting heritage of culture on social media may urge to spread information to more people quickly and effectively.
 - f. Best wishes.
-

PASSAGE 48

Apprentice Administrator in a Car Dealership

A successful car dealership specializing in second-hand cars is looking for an apprentice administrator to provide administrative support for the team.

This would be a fantastic opportunity for someone looking for an entry-level position in administration as no experience is required. The ideal candidate should also be able to work on Saturdays.

PASSAGE 49

- a. Additionally, prioritize your activities by deciding which tasks are the most urgent and important and then, concentrate on these first.
 - b. Firstly, make a plan for things you need to do, including appointments and deadlines by using a diary or apps on mobile devices to remind you of what you need to accomplish and when you need to accomplish it.
 - c. Finally, develop routines because routines, when established, take less time for you to do your tasks.
 - d. Time management skills are not hard to develop; once you master them, you will find out that they are great keys to success and you can become independent.
 - e. Many young people strive to be independent and to live independently, you need to develop time-management skills.
-

PASSAGE 50

Your cooperation is vital for optimal care. If you've taken any medications recently—prescription, over-the-counter, or herbal—kindly inform your nurse. Your honesty

ensures tailored treatment, minimizing risks and maximizing benefits. Your active involvement empowers us to provide the best possible care. Thank you for your understanding and assistance in promoting your well-being. For any questions, don't hesitate to contact our staff.

Together, we're committed to your health journey.

PASSAGE 51

- a. There are also many music festivals around the globe that bring artists and music fans together.
 - b. People nowadays enjoy listening to music from different countries and cultures, and in different languages.
 - c. Thanks to globalization, people can quickly discover new music from all over the world.
 - d. To sum up, in today's connected world, it is very common for musicians across the world to work on music projects and share ideas together.
 - e. For example, American teens are captivated by K-pop music and dance.
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PASSAGE 52

- a. Moreover, engaging in household chores teaches valuable life skills, including time management and organisation.
- b. Finally, sharing household responsibilities promotes teamwork and fosters a sense of unity within the family.
- c. Encouraging kids to do household chores offers numerous benefits.
- d. Additionally, it fosters a strong work ethic and independence as children learn to complete tasks on their own.
- e. By assigning tasks such as tidying up their rooms or helping with meal preparation,

children learn the importance of contributing to the family's well-being.

f. Overall, involving kids in household chores helps them develop essential life skills while contributing positively to family dynamics.

g. Firstly, it instils a sense of responsibility from a young age.

PASSAGE 53

a. Additionally, we've started a garden to provide a safe space for local wildlife to thrive.

b. Warm regards.

c. I'm excited to share some great news about recent initiatives at our school to protect wildlife.

d. Lastly, students are actively involved in organising awareness campaigns and fundraisers to support wildlife conservation efforts.

e. Dear John, I hope this letter finds you well!

f. Overall, these initiatives reflect our commitment to preserving biodiversity and making a positive impact on the environment.

g. Firstly, our school has implemented a recycling programme to reduce waste and protect habitats.

PASSAGE 54

There are around 7,000 languages in the world today. However, most people speak the largest languages: Chinese, Spanish, English, Hindi, Russian, Arabic, and others.

So what about the smaller languages? According to the UNESCO Atlas of the World's Languages in Danger, around one-third of the world's languages now has fewer than 1,000 speakers. We may soon lose those languages completely. In fact, 230 languages became extinct between 1950 and 2010.

Unfortunately, when we lose a language, we also lose its culture and knowledge. That's because people in different places have different ways of living and thinking. One example of this is the Tuvan language of southern Siberia. Tuvan people depend on animals for food and other basic needs. Their language shows this close connection between people and animals. The Tuvan word *ezenggiler*, for example, means "to sing with the rhythms of riding a horse." And the word *ak byzaa* is "a white calf less than one year old."

PASSAGE 55

In some places, people are working to save traditional languages. Many schools in New Zealand now teach the Maori language. This helps connect native New Zealanders to their Maori culture. And Welsh is spoken by around 500,000 people in Wales. The Welsh government is working to increase that number to one million by 2050.

Technology offers a possible alternative to saving endangered languages. National Geographic's Enduring Voices project has created "Talking Dictionaries" – the recorded voices of people communicating with each other. All of them are fluent speakers of endangered languages. And because these dictionaries are accessible to anyone on the Internet, people now and in the future can learn some of the vocabulary, greetings, and grammar rules of past languages.

PASSAGE 56

Getting work experience is a good way for young people who are still at school to see whether they would enjoy a particular career. Future employers like to know about their work experience which they think is important for them in the process of recruiting employees. And young people get the chance to consider many possibilities for a future career with working professionals. In addition, they will find these professionals' advice specially helpful thinking about the different choices they will have to make.

Work experience often involves uncomfortable situations, but people who are in such situations can learn how to behave appropriately in front of clients and how to respond to things in the workplace. Appearance is also important and they need to dress suitably whether they are going for a job as an engineer or an IT specialist, or a job which is perhaps less technical but equally demanding, such as a medical doctor or a teacher.

PASSAGE 57

Device-centred communication has become almost universal over the past twenty years. More than three quarters of people in the world now own a mobile device, and more than half communicate via social networking. It is now hard to imagine a world without mobile devices consisting of such things as mobile phones, laptops, and tablets. They allow us to stay in touch with a large network of friends, no matter where they are. But many experts say that communicating with a device is nothing like talking with someone in person. "Body language, eye contact, and tone of voice can tell us so much," psychologist Mary Peters says. "And none of those exist on a device. Even video chat removes many subtle clues." We don't know to what extent these technologies will permanently change the way people interact. People will always want to meet up with others in small and large groups. Indeed, it is fair to say

that social media makes it easier than ever before for people to organise social events. However, there is still a danger that device-centred communication may have a negative long-term impact on the way people interact with each other on a day-to-day basis. We must not, therefore, lose sight of the need to focus on the actual people around us, and remember that they deserve our real – not virtual – attention. The idea of a culture where people always have a screen between them sounds a bit funny, because deep understanding comes when we see the reactions on other people's faces.

PASSAGE 58

Stress is with us all the time. It comes from mental or emotional activity as well as physical activity. It is unique and personal to each of us. So personal, in fact, that what may be relaxing to one person may be stressful to another. For example, if you are a busy executive who likes to keep occupied all of the time, “taking it easy” at the beach on a beautiful day may feel extremely frustrating, nonproductive, and upsetting. You may be emotionally distressed from “doing nothing”. Too much emotional stress can cause physical illnesses such as high blood pressure, ulcers, or even heart disease. Physical stress from work or exercise is not likely to cause such ailments. The truth is that physical exercise can help you to relax and to better handle your mental or emotional stress.

PASSAGE 59

The population of the world has increased more in modern times than in all other ages of history combined. World population totalled about 500 million in 1650. It doubled in the period from 1650 - 1850. Today the population is more than five billion. Estimates based on research by the United Nations indicate that it will more than double in the twenty-five years between 1975 and the year 2000, reaching seven billion by the turn of the century. No one knows the limits of population that the earth can support. Thomas Malthus, an English economist, developed a theory that became widely accepted in the nineteenth century. He suggested that because world population tended to increase more rapidly than the food supply, a continual strain was exerted upon available resources. Malthus cited wars, famines, epidemics, and other disasters as the usual limitations of population growth. With recent advances in science and technology, including improved agricultural methods and great strides in medicine, some of the limiting factors in population growth have been lessened, with obvious results. International organizations have put forward several recommendations to alleviate the problem of overpopulation, including an increase in food production, general economic development in target areas, and a decrease in birth rates. Most experts agree that it will be necessary to combine all three recommendations in an effort to effect a lasting solution.

PASSAGE 60

To Whom It May Concern, I spent most of the last two days calling your customer service lines in an effort to resolve this situation, but I have gotten nowhere. So, I'm writing in the hopes that this letter will get into the hands of a more effective person. I'm really hoping you can help me. On Monday, May 16th, I was in the airport checking my baggage for a flight to Amsterdam, and the young man who was helping me - James Strathcona was his name - tore the handle of my suitcase when he was

lifting it onto the conveyor belt. I have inquired as to how much it would cost to fix and was told it would be at least US\$45.00. I have enclosed a photocopy of the quote from the repairman. On principle, I really feel these repairs ought to be paid by World Travel, as the damage was done while one of your people was handling my luggage. However, I am being given the run-around by your customer service staff whenever I call. One young man was even so bold as to suggest that the suitcase was probably worn out and ready to break anyway. I assure you that this is not true: I only recently bought the set, and the only reason it was broken was that it was handled with excessive force. In all other dealings I've had with your company, I have had very positive experiences and I have no wish to fly with another airline. I look forward to hearing from you soon, and I very much appreciate your help. Yours faithfully,

PASSAGE 61

Unmarried Women Becoming Homeowners

An increasing number of single women are buying their own homes, according to industry experts. By contrast, the figures for unmarried men buying houses or apartments show no increase. What is behind this trend? I put the question to analysts at the Real Estate Institute, who came up with the following observations:

Women no longer seek marriage and a homemaking role as their first priority, but want a stable job or career instead, and this puts them in a position where they can own a home independently. Single men are no longer pressured to "settle down", which traditionally means getting a stable job with a career path and then getting married and buying a house. They tend, therefore, to be less likely to have stable jobs.

Women are increasingly better qualified and in many areas have surpassed men. This enables them to obtain better and more highly paid jobs. Women seem to be more capable of seeking good advice and completing the formalities of obtaining a

mortgage. Experts at the institute expect the trend to continue, as home ownership provides financial and emotional security for women who are not yet ready to seek a "partner for life".

PASSAGE 62

Traditionally in America, helping the poor was a matter for private charities or local governments. Arriving immigrants depended mainly on predecessors from their homeland to help them start a new life. In the late 19th and early 20th centuries, several European nations instituted public-welfare programs. But such a movement was slow to take hold in the United States because the rapid pace of industrialization and the ready availability of farmland seemed to confirm the belief that anyone who was willing to work could find a job.

Most of the programs started during the Depression era were temporary relief measures, but one of the programs – Social Security – has become an American institution. Paid for by deductions from the paychecks of working people, Social Security ensures that retired persons receive a modest monthly income and also provides unemployment insurance, disability insurance, and other assistance to those who need it. Social Security payments to retired persons can start at age 62, but many wait until age 65, when the payments are slightly higher. Recently, there has been concern that the Social Security fund may not have enough money to fulfill its obligations in the 21st century, when the population of elderly Americans is expected to increase dramatically. Policy makers have proposed various ways to make up the anticipated deficit, but a long-term solution is still being debated.

In the years since Roosevelt, other American presidents have established assistance programs. These include Medicaid and Medicare; food stamps, certificates that people can use to purchase food; and public housing which is built at federal expense and made available to persons on low incomes.

Needy Americans can also turn to sources other than the government for help. A broad spectrum of private charities and voluntary organizations is available. Volunteerism is on the rise in the United States, especially among retired persons. It is estimated that almost 50 percent of Americans over age 18 do volunteer work, and nearly 75 percent of U.S. households contribute money to charity.

PASSAGE 63

It has been thought that women are the second class in citizen, and men are the first. There is not a real equality of opportunity for men and women. Years ago, people were living in a man-dominated society. Women had to obey their husbands and fathers absolutely. Women's place was in the kitchen and women's work was housework. In many places, women were not even allowed to go to school. Women had no rights, even the right to choose husband for themselves. Men usually occupied high positions in society so they thought they were more intelligent than women. Men often considered women as their property. Sometimes, they mistreated by their husbands and suffered the problem as a fate. Many parents did not even want to have daughters.

Despite the progress, there remain outdated beliefs about women's roles, traditionally passed down from generation to generation. Men are commonly seen as the strong bodies, bread-winners in the family, and key leaders in society, while women are restricted to being housewives, child bearing and care, and housework such as washing and cooking.

According to social surveys, many women in the 21st century still have to work over 12 hours a day including working in offices and doing countless household chores without any help from their husbands. In some regions, the labor of women is not recognized despite the hardships they endure to support the whole family. Moreover, women are the direct victims of family violence, especially in rural areas.

Thanks to the women's liberation movement, nowadays women have proved that they are equal to men in every aspect. An average woman has weaker muscles than an average man, but she may be as intelligent as he is. Women can do everything that men can, and women can do one thing that no man can: they produce children.

PASSAGE 64

Basic to any understanding of Canada in the 20 years after the Second World War is the country's impressive population growth. For every three Canadians in 1945, there were over five in 1966. In September 1966, Canada's population passed the 20 million mark.

Most of this surging growth came from natural increase. The depression of the 1930s and the war had held back marriages, and the catching-up process began after 1945. The baby boom continued through the decade of the 1950s, producing a population increase of nearly fifteen percent in the five years from 1951 to 1956. This rate of increase had been exceeded only once before in Canada's history, in the decade before 1911, when the prairies were being settled.

Undoubtedly, the good economic conditions of the 1950s supported a growth in the population, but the expansion also derived from a trend toward earlier marriages and an increase in the average size of families. In 1957, the Canadian birth rate stood at 28 per thousand, one of the highest in the world.

After the peak year of 1957, the birth rate in Canada began to decline. It continued falling until in 1966 it stood at the lowest level in 25 years. Partly this decline reflected the low level of births during the depression and the war, but it was also caused by changes in Canadian society.

PASSAGE 65

Young people were staying at school longer; more women were working; young married couples were buying automobiles or houses before starting families; rising living standards were cutting down the size of families.

It appeared that Canada was once more falling in step with the trend toward smaller families that had occurred all through the Western world since the time of the Industrial Revolution.

Although the growth in Canada's population had slowed down by 1966, the increase in the first half of the 1960s was only nine percent.

Another large population wave was coming over the horizon. It would be composed of the children who were born during the period of the high birth rate prior to 1957.

PASSAGE 66

When you first apply for the job, you might not succeed in getting it.

It's always a good idea to ask them to explain to you what prevented you from beating the other candidates. Don't complain about the situation, but ask them to advise you on what you can do better next time.

Perhaps the interviewers disproved of or disagreed with something you said. Perhaps they just glance at your application and saw something that made it easy to choose between you and another candidate.

Don't regard it as a failure, but recognize it as a chance to learn more. As long as you don't worry too much about it and continue to believe in yourself, you'll eventually find the chance you've been waiting for.

Then your family and friends will congratulate you on your success!

PASSAGE 67

Preparation is a key to a successful interview. Does the idea of going to a job interview make you feel a little nervous?

Many people find that they find it is the hardest part of the employing process. But it is not really true. The more you prepare and practice, the more comfortable you will feel.

You should find out as much as possible about the company before you go to the interview. Understand the products that they produce and the services that they provide.

It is also good to know who the customers are and who the major competitors are. Practice makes perfect. It will also make you feel more confident and relaxed.

So, practice your answers to common questions. Make a list of questions to ask, too. Almost all interviewers will ask if you have any questions.

This is a great opportunity for you to show your keenness, enthusiasm, and knowledge.

Make a great impression. The interview is your chance to show that you are the best person for the job.

Your application or resume has already exhibited that you are qualified. Now it is up to you to show how your skills and experience match this position and this company. The employer will be looking and listening to determine if you are a good fit. He will be looking for a number of different qualities, in addition to the skills that you possess.

To make the best impression:

- Dress appropriately.
- Express your strengths.
- Arrive early, by about 10–15 minutes.
- Be enthusiastic.
- Shake hands firmly.

- Be an active listener.
 - Sit up straight and maintain eye contact.
 - Ask questions.
-

PASSAGE 68

After the interview, follow up with a thank-you note. This is a chance for you to restate your interest and how you can benefit the company.

Your best bet is to time it so that the note gets there before the hiring decision is made.

You should also follow up with a phone call if you do not hear back from the employer within the specified time.

PASSAGE 69

It is very difficult to succeed in the music business; nine out of ten bands that release a first record fail to produce a second.

Surviving in the music industry requires luck and patience, but most of all it requires an intricate knowledge of how a record company functions.

The process begins when a representative of a company's Artists and Repertoire (A & R) department visits bars and night clubs, scouting for young, talented bands. After the representative identifies a promising band, he or she will work to negotiate a contract with that band.

The signing of this recording contract is a slow process. A company will spend a long time investigating the band itself as well as current trends in popular music.

During this period, it is important that a band reciprocate with an investigation of its own, learning as much as possible about the record company and making personal connections within the different departments that will handle their recordings.

Once a band has signed the contract and has finished recording an album, the Publicity and Promotions department takes over.

This department decides whether or not to mass produce and market the band's album.

Most bands fail to make personal contacts in this second department, thus losing their voice in the important final process of producing and marketing their album.

This loss of voice often contributes to the band's failure as a recording group.

PASSAGE 70

Scientists have revealed that air pollution may be responsible for a significant reduction in intelligence. Research conducted for the World Health Organization (WHO) in China showed that air pollution resulted in notable falls in students' test scores. The study, in which researchers analyzed verbal and arithmetic tests taken by 20,000 people of all ages, took place within a period of four years.

The researchers say that their study can be considered as a warning to the rest of the world, especially to those who live in urban areas, adding that the longer people are left exposed from polluted air, the greater the damage to their intelligence will be. According to WHO, over 91 percent of the world population live in areas with toxic air. One of the researchers warned: "There is no shortcut to solve this issue. Therefore, governments really need to take strong measures to reduce air pollution."

PASSAGE 71

Ha Long Bay, located in Quang Ninh Province, Vietnam, was recognized as a World Heritage Site by UNESCO in 1994. Over the years, Ha Long Bay has attracted numerous visitors who come to enjoy its breathtaking views and experience other activities.

Ha Long Bay is well-known for its beautiful scenery. With its thousands of rocks and caves emerging out of the water, Ha Long Bay has won international recognition. As visitors explore this magnificent place, there are always new surprises for them. Cruise tours are very popular in Ha Long Bay. There are different cruise itineraries so tourists can visit many different caves, and experience the local culture and life on the water. Thus, a tour may last from several hours to a day, or even a night on board, which gives the visitors a truly superb experience.

Ha Long Bay cuisine presents another attraction for tourists. It is famous for its fresh seafood, such as crabs, prawns, and sea clams. A trip to Ha Long Bay is not complete without tasting the authentic local food served in many restaurants in the area.

Tourists can also do and see a lot in Ha Long Bay at a reasonable price. They can save money thanks to the availability of low-cost hotels and cruise tours. For those with more abundant travel budget, there are also many options. They can enjoy the comfort and elegance of five-star hotels and luxury cruise ships.

The experiences of each visitor to Ha Long Bay vary. Some may remember waking up to a beautiful sunrise among the rocks, islets, and caves. Others may never forget their cave dinner or the breathtaking view from a mountain top overlooking the bay. However, they will all be left with unforgettable memories of their Ha Long Bay tour.

PASSAGE 72

Without music and sport classes, a child's talent in these areas may never be discovered and developed. In fact, classrooms may provide an environment for these children to expose their potential in these fields. Furthermore, even for children with extraordinary talents, their capabilities may not fully grow unless some basic lessons are offered.

Children may also learn to be disciplined and hardworking from the atmosphere of a

class, because success in these particular areas requires a significant amount of effort in training. In brief, school education may satisfy some of the most critical factors in the early progress of future music and sport figures.

More importantly, the provision of both academic, music, and sports education is mandatory for an all-rounded growth of young students. If learning to sing or to play a sport, for example, is treated as an extracurricular activity only, children may consider the engagement in it to be entirely optional. Some children, particularly those without a determined mindset, may eventually choose not to play sports or music. Such a group may consequently suffer from physical or mental illness in later life.

To conclude, to ensure the adequate physical and mental development of the next generation, and to foster young talents in music and sports, these subjects must never be abandoned in any child educational institution.

PASSAGE 73

Over the past decade, many priceless heritage sites and monuments have been damaged in countries across the world. In Africa, sites in Libya, Algeria, Egypt, and Mali, among others, have been damaged during internal and cross-border conflicts. The three main threats to heritage sites are development projects, armed conflicts, and natural disasters. International agencies like UNESCO have called for the protection of heritage resources in the event of conflict. But this has not happened.

Destroying monuments is a violent act. Those responsible are trying to erase - by force - an aspect of history. One example was the Nazis who, during World War II, tried to destroy Jewish people's art and personal property. The attacks on monuments and calls for their destruction reflect the systemic and complex violence in many African states, although it's important to note that the problem is not only an African one. ISIS is the latest group destroying history and heritage. This is popular in Iraq.

Syria is another country witnessing its heritage being wiped out. When examining the ongoing conflict in the north of Mali, it is clear that heritage sites are just part of the damage of human lives and cultural property in the ongoing conflict.

It is worth considering national and world heritage conservation policies and guidelines. All heritage is valuable and should be protected. Destroying heritage is not in the interest of humanity. The African continent has to address the question of how we collectively deal with difficult and damaged heritages. A reflection on the UNESCO Conventions between 1954 and 1972 should also provide guidance on future actions on heritage management at local and national levels. The 1954 Convention which calls for the protection of cultural heritage during conflict and war was regularly mentioned during the Iraq conflict and recent conflict in Mali. The 1970 and 1972 Conventions draw attention to protecting world heritage by state parties, with these tools, countries should have enough guidance to individually and collectively protect heritage resources.

PASSAGE 74

Becoming independent is an important milestone in everyone's life. It allows individuals to make their own decisions and learn from their own experiences. This process is essential for maturing into a responsible and self-reliant adult.

When people start to manage their own time and resources, they often find that they are more capable than they realized. Taking control of their finances, for instance, can teach young adults valuable lessons about budgeting. By paying bills, saving money, and making financial plans for the future, they develop a sense of independence which is crucial for long-term stability.

Additionally, independence is not just about living alone or relying on others. It's about making choices that align with personal values and goals. When young people make choices about their education, career, or personal life, they lay the foundation for their future.

In conclusion, the journey towards independence can be challenging but it is also rewarding. As individuals grow and progress on this path, they discover more about their strengths, passions, and the direction they wish to take in life.

PASSAGE 75

When you graduate from high school or university, is learning finished? The answer is no. In many countries, people continue learning all their lives. Why is lifelong learning important? How can it help you?

Lifelong learning can be useful in many ways. People who want to change careers often return to study at a university. Some professionals require employees to keep learning new ways to do things. For example, doctors and nurses must always learn about new illnesses and treatments. Moreover, they must practice the skills they have and keep learning new ones.

Lifelong learning can help people stay healthy and independent. Many older people also feel that lifelong learning helps them stay close to young people. Lots of older people are now learning how to use computers. “I want to live active for my own health,” said Mr. Salinas, a 91-year-old man taking computer classes. “I see my computer learning as part of an active life and something that I can share with my family.”

PASSAGE 76

The world needs to do more to prepare for the impact of a rapidly aging population,

the UN has warned - particularly in developing countries. Within 10 years, the number of people aged over 60 will pass one billion, a report by the UN Population Fund said. The demographic shift will present huge challenges to countries' welfare, pension, and healthcare systems. The UN agency also said more had to be done to tackle abuse, neglect, and violence against older persons.

The number of older people worldwide is growing faster than any other age group. The report, *Ageing in the 21st Century: A Celebration and a Challenge*, estimates that one in nine people around the world is older than 60. The elderly population is expected to swell by 200 million in the next decade to surpass one billion, and reach two billion by 2050. This rising proportion of older people is a consequence of success - improved nutrition, sanitation, healthcare, education, and economic well-being are contributing factors, the report says.

But the UN and a charity that also contributed to the report, Help Age International, say the aging population is being widely mismanaged. "In many developing countries with large populations of young people, the challenge is that governments have not put policies and practices in place to support their current older populations or made enough preparations for 2050," the agencies said in a joint statement.

PASSAGE 77

There are more than one billion cows in the world, and cow farming is a large source of methane emissions. This colorless and odorless gas is much more powerful than CO₂ at warming the earth. Farmers and companies are developing solutions for decreasing cows' methane emissions. In Canada and Brazil, farmers started adding a special ingredient to their animals' feed to reduce cows' methane production. In New Zealand, scientists are working on a vaccine which can cut methane emissions. Rather than stopping methane emissions, a UK company has designed face masks to

catch the gas before it is released. The masks will allow cows to continue their normal diet but will turn methane into CO₂ and water. They can fit comfortably on the cow's head and can be adjusted to different head sizes. Sensors on the masks can notice when methane comes out of the cow's mouth and provide the percentage of the gas which can cut methane emissions. This information can also be useful for farmers who can use it to identify the early signs of disease. For example, if a cow eats less, but produces more methane than usual, it may have a health problem. It is predicted that the need for beef and dairy products will go up in the coming years. The company developing the methane-catching masks hopes that farmers will start using their invention, which will slow down global warming.

PASSAGE 78

Cultural heritage preservation means keeping traditions and customs of a community against factors that try to change them negatively. Some common examples are restoring historical buildings, passing on an ancient craft, or recording traditional tales. Cultural heritage is crucial for communities. It helps them look back on their history in a way which informs their cultural identity. Cultural heritage preservation encourages as well as utilizes tourism. Heritage Tourism is one of the major ways to preserve cultural heritage and reduce poverty in a community. It often boosts the local economy and can become one of its major industries. Many tourists visit cultural sites and partake in cultural activities while traveling to these places. As tourism increases, more jobs for local residents such as museum guides or local restaurant and shop owners are created. Employers can then afford to pay their employees. Furthermore, cultural heritage preservation also reduces poverty and maintains cultural values by passing down artisan crafts to new generations. Another

advantage of preserving cultural heritage is that this can help the new generations take pride themselves on their ancestors and country.

PASSAGE 79

Due to natural disasters or man-made damages during the war, while others may take a lot of time and cost to repair. Rebuilding cultural heritage sites and artifacts is similar to solving a big jigsaw puzzle without knowing what it should look like. One project has been run by a group of scientists to help with the restoration of heritage sites. The technologies used in the project include robotics, 3-D scanning, modern machines, and artificial intelligence. These artifact pieces are scanned by high-tech computers to predict their original architecture. Throughout the process, the computer system is guided by humans to ensure accurate rebuilding. The second component involves using robots to scan and connect the pieces. These robots resemble an average person to save time and human resources when gathering information.

PASSAGE 80

Some of the world's energy may already come from fossil fuels, such as oil, gas, and coal, while others may rely on nuclear power. More than 80 percent of the world's energy comes from fossil fuels. However, fossil fuels cause problems like air pollution and environmental damage when extracted from the Earth. Nuclear power has advantages such as being inexhaustible and cleaner. Thirty-one countries and many ships use nuclear power. However, nuclear energy also brings problems like serious accidents. For instance, accidents in Ukraine in 1986 and Japan in 2011

caused severe damage. Many people oppose nuclear energy due to safety concerns. There have been protests against it in countries like the United States, Russia, and Japan. Despite this, more countries are turning to nuclear power as fossil fuels run out. However, this choice might lead to bigger problems in the future.

PASSAGE 81

Some children may have already had music classes when they attend school, while others may find music helps them learn other subjects better. Some studies have shown that music training can help you understand your own language better. It could also help you with learning a second one. Moreover, young people who have studied music seem to get higher scores in other subjects like maths. Music also helps you think of new ideas, and believe more in yourself. If you are learning the guitar, for example, it can be exciting when you are able to start composing your own music. One of the biggest benefits, of course, is that listening to music can reduce your stress. Composing music can make you feel the same way. Maybe your musical knowledge will open up a great career path for you in the future!

PASSAGE 82

Some people may have already regarded ecotourism as responsible and sustainable travel to natural areas that conserves the environment and improves the well-being of residents, while others may argue that it prioritises the environment above the needs of local inhabitants. At its core, ecotourism assumes that conservation must pay for itself. Supporters argue it involves residents in accommodating tourists and acting as guides. Communities often work as equal partners with ecotourism

organisations. However, some detractors point out ecotourism can prioritise the environment above residents' needs. This obsession, rather than boosting wealth, can damage the ability of the majority to escape poverty.

PASSAGE 83

Some games may have already become popular worldwide, like Monopoly, which is sold in 80 countries and comes in 26 different languages, while others may struggle to gain popularity. At the beginning of the 20th century, Elizabeth Magie, a political activist, created The Landlord's Game. Its purpose was to teach people how the rich accumulate wealth by exploiting the poor. However, the game was not popular and sold very few copies. In 1934, Charles Darrow redesigned it into a game of chance. When he presented it to Parker Brothers, they rejected it, saying it was too complex and flawed. Darrow persisted and produced over 5,000 handmade sets to sell locally. The game became immensely popular, prompting Parker Brothers to buy the rights to Monopoly.

PASSAGE 84

Some places may have already experienced significant environmental changes, like Alaska, where fifteen percent of the land has disappeared since the 1950s, while others may not yet face such drastic effects. The problem in Alaska is melting glaciers. With more than 100,000 glaciers, accounting for five percent of the state's area, most glaciers are retreating or diminishing. This is due to rising global temperatures. For example, since the 1960s, Alaska's average temperature has risen by 3°C. Another problem is thawing permafrost. Much of Alaska's land was

permanently frozen, but now the thawing is causing issues such as collapsing roads and utility poles. Coastal residents are forced to relocate as beaches erode. The forests in Alaska are also affected. Melting permafrost allows insects like the spruce-bark beetle to reproduce faster, damaging trees more rapidly. If temperatures continue to rise, the forests may not survive by the turn of the century. Scientists believe human activity contributes to rising temperatures. Regardless of the cause, the warming climate is affecting Alaska, potentially foreshadowing the future of the planet.

PASSAGE 85

The future role of women can be looked at more optimistically. Nowadays, there seems to be recognition of the vital role women play in society, and more status is given to women. Overall, excellent progress has been made in education. This has played a powerful role for women's self-esteem. It demonstrates women's intellectual abilities to gain expertise in the field of their choice. However, this progress has still to be reflected in the job market. Since a more educated society is good for industry and society as a whole, it is even more urgent for women to gain an acceptable status in their profession. The message is that women have the ability to change their roles and that they will demand to have the means to do it. It is generally accepted by the new generation of young men and women that co-operation and mutual aid are far more productive than the divider camp of men and women. Society is changing, and with it the role of men and women. In many fields, women have come a long way from just their roles as mothers and homemakers. They no longer think that children rearing and home management are their sole duties.

PASSAGE 86

The word “grandparents” is descriptive of the unique dual parenting role that this generation assumes. It emphasizes the vital part they play in family life. With a wealth of old-world experience behind them, and with the unique ability to metamorphose from advisers or mediators into listeners or friends, they can offer support and stability in an ever-changing world. Grandparents perform a balancing act between the needs of their adult children and those of their grandchildren. This role is varied. It is imperial at times, muted at others. It goes underground whenever required, but it is solid and absolutely dependable. Grandparents often bridge the gap between parents and children. Rebellious, independent children who are trying to find their feet are almost always at loggerheads with their parents. The role of grandparents can be very important provided that they act as impartial judges and are able to convey this feeling to both parties. One important thing, which seems to be missing in the lives of children today, is a sense of family, values, beliefs, and principles. This is where the grandparents step in. However, instilling beliefs and values is not as easy as it was fifty or sixty years ago.

PASSAGE 87

The Plastiki looks similar to many other boats in Sydney harbour. It's eighteen metres long, six metres wide, and it weighs about twelve thousand kilogrammes. It carries a crew of six people and has an average speed of five knots. However, once you get near to the Plastiki, you realise there's a big difference. It's made of twelve thousand five hundred re-used plastic bottles. David de Rothschild is an environmentalist who has crossed Antarctica and explored the Ecuadorian Amazon. One day, he was reading some information about all the plastic in the seas and oceans. He couldn't believe what he was reading. For example, humans throw away four out of every five

plastic bottles they use, and plastic rubbish causes about eighty percent of the pollution in the sea. In addition, scientists think that around one million seabirds die every year from plastic pollution. De Rothschild decided he wanted to help fight pollution in the sea. To help more people understand the problem, he started building a boat made of plastic bottles. As well as building the boat with recycled plastic, it was important for him to make the boat environmentally friendly and user-friendly. The boat uses renewable energy such as wind power and solar energy. The crew can make meals with vegetables from the small garden at the back of the boat. They can take a break from work and get some exercise by using the special exercise bicycle. The energy from the bike provides power for the boat's computers. And if anyone needs to take a shower, the boat's shower uses saltwater from the sea.

PASSAGE 88

The change in the global surface temperature between 1850 and the end of the 21st Century is likely to exceed 1.5°C, most simulations suggest. The WMO says that if the current warming trend continues, temperatures could rise 3-5°C by the end of this century. Temperature rises of 2°C had long been regarded as the gateway to dangerous warming. More recently, scientists and policymakers have argued that limiting temperature rises to 1.5°C is safer. An Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) report in 2018 suggested that keeping to the 1.5°C target would require “rapid, far-reaching and unprecedented changes in all aspects of society.” The UN is leading a political effort to stabilise greenhouse-gas emissions, for as long as we continue to emit greenhouse gases, temperatures will continue to rise. China emits more CO₂ than any other country. It is followed by the US and the European Union member states, although emissions per person are much greater there. But

even if we now cut greenhouse-gas emissions dramatically, scientists say the effects will continue. Large bodies of water and ice can take hundreds of years to respond to changes in temperature. And it takes CO₂ decades to be removed from the atmosphere. As more CO₂ is released into the atmosphere, uptake of the gas by the oceans increases, causing the water to become more acidic. This could pose major problems for coral reefs. Global warming will cause further changes that are likely to create further heating. This includes the release of large quantities of methane as permafrost - frozen soil found mainly at high latitudes - melts. Responding to climate change will be one of the biggest challenges we face this century. As the world warms, more water evaporates, leading to more moisture in the air. This means many areas will experience more intense rainfall - and in some places snowfall. But the risk of drought in inland areas during hot summers will increase. More flooding is expected from storms and rising sea levels. But there are likely to be very strong regional variations in these patterns.

PASSAGE 89

The environment encompasses the complex interplay of living organisms and their surroundings, encompassing both the natural and built elements of our planet. It is a delicate balance where ecosystems thrive, providing essential services such as clean air, water, and fertile soil that sustain life. The health of the environment is intricately linked to human well-being as it influences climate patterns, biodiversity, and the availability of resources. Unfortunately, human activities, such as industrialization, deforestation, and pollution, have led to widespread environmental degradation. This degradation poses significant threats to biodiversity, accelerates climate change, and jeopardizes the sustainability of our planet. Recognizing the urgency of preserving and restoring the environment, global efforts are underway to promote sustainable

practices, conserve natural resources, and mitigate the impacts of human activities. The responsibility lies with individuals, communities, and nations alike to adopt environmentally conscious behaviors and policies to safeguard the health and resilience of our shared home.

PASSAGE 90

Cultural beliefs differ as to whether directness or indirectness is considered positive. In mainstream American culture, the ideal form of communication includes being direct rather than indirect. "Ideal" here means that the culture values this style, although not everyone speaks directly. There are several expressions in English which emphasize the importance of being direct: "Get to the point! Don't beat around the bush! Let's get down to business!" These sayings all indicate the importance of dealing directly with issues rather than avoiding them. One way to determine whether a culture favors a direct or indirect style in communication is to find out how the people in that culture express disagreement or how they say "No". In Japan, there are at least fifteen ways of saying "No" without actually saying the word. Similarly, in some countries, there are different ways to disagree. For example, it would be considered rude to say directly "I disagree with you" or "You're wrong". Many Americans believe that "honesty is the best policy" and their communication style reflects this. Honesty and directness in communication are strongly related. It is not a surprise, then, to find out that cultural groups misjudge each other based on different beliefs about directness and honesty in communication.

PASSAGE 91

The generation gap that was so in evidence during the 60s has resurfaced, but it is not the disruptive force that it was during the Vietnam era, a 2009 study suggests. The Pew Research Center study found that 79% of Americans see major differences between younger and older adults in the way they look at the world. In 1969, a Gallup Poll found that a smaller percentage, 74%, perceived major differences. Today, however, although more Americans see generational differences, most do not see them as divisive. That is partly because the areas of difference. The top areas of disagreement between young and old, according to the Pew Research Study, are the use of technology and taste in music. Grandparents are likely to have observed these differences in their grandchildren who are tweens, teens, and young adults. If large differences between the generations exist, why don't they spawn conflict? The answer is twofold. First, the two largest areas of difference—technology and music—are less emotionally charged than political issues. The older generation is likely to be proud of the younger generation's prowess in technology rather than to view it as a problem. As for the musical differences, each generation wants its own style of music, and the older generation generally can relate to that desire. Second, in the other areas of difference, the younger generation tends to regard the older generation as superior to their own generation—clearly a difference from the 1960s with its rallying cry of “Don't trust anyone over thirty”. According to the Pew study, all generations regard older Americans as superior in moral values, work ethic, and respect for others.

PASSAGE 92

International Student Volunteers (ISV) is a California-based non-profit volunteer organization. Since 2002, more than 35,000 students have joined ISV to volunteer and make a difference during their summer break. One of ISV's programs, High

School Program (HSP), combining volunteer work and adventure travel, is an 18-day program for high school students aged 15-18. Since its first launch in 2007 in Australia, HSP has provided opportunities for students to make a difference to communities and those in need while they are learning about responsibility and global issues. Each group of students is led by a seasoned ISV leader, and accompanied by a High School leader—either teacher or coach throughout their trip. HSP's regional staff are available to provide timely help. Students can live, travel, and learn in a fun environment. There are a lot of activities that build good characters and inspire students to contribute their efforts. For a couple of days, students can visit local areas and learn about their cultures or difficulties faced by local people. For the other days, they can join adventure activities to step out of their comfort zone and challenge themselves. High school students can choose among three countries—Costa Rica, Dominican Republic, or Thailand—to spend their trip. HSP intends to expand their network to other countries. If you're a high school student, give it a shot!

PASSAGE 93

We need to attend to the tree loss because of the following benefits of trees. Firstly, trees provide shade for homes, office buildings, parks, and roadways, cooling surface temperatures. They also take in and evaporate water, which cools the air around them. Secondly, trees absorb carbon and remove pollutants from the atmosphere. Trees also reduce energy costs by \$4 billion a year, according to Nowak's study. "The shading of those trees on buildings reduces your air conditioning costs. Take those trees away; now your buildings are heating up, you're running your air conditioning more, and you're burning more fuel from the power plants, so the pollution and emissions go up." Besides, trees act as water filters, taking in dirty surface water and absorbing nitrogen and phosphorus into the soil. Last but not least, many studies have

found connections between exposure to nature and better mental and physical health. Some hospitals have added tree views and plantings for patients as a result of these studies. Doctors are even prescribing walks in nature for children and families due to evidence that nature exposure lowers blood pressure and stress hormones. And studies have associated living near green areas with lower death rates.

PASSAGE 94

After inventing dynamite, Swedish-born Alfred Nobel became a very rich man. However, he foresaw its universally destructive powers too late. Nobel preferred not to be remembered as the inventor of dynamite, so in 1895, just two weeks before his death, he created a fund to be used for awarding prizes to people who had made worthwhile contributions to humanity. Originally, there were five awards: literature, physics, chemistry, medicine, and peace. Economics was added in 1968, just sixty-seven years after the first awards ceremony. Nobel's original legacy of nine million dollars was invested, and the interest on this sum is used for the awards, which vary from \$30,000 to \$125,000. Every year, on December 10, the anniversary of Nobel's death, the awards—gold medal, illuminated diploma, and money—are presented to the winners. Sometimes, politics plays an important role in the judges' decisions. Americans have won numerous science awards, but relatively few literature prizes. No awards were presented from 1940 to 1942 at the beginning of World War II. Some people have won two prizes, but this is rare; others have shared their prizes.

PASSAGE 95

We all experience joy and sorrow in our lives, but have we ever wondered why we need both? Some people might think that joy is the only thing worth pursuing, and that sorrow is something to avoid at all costs. However, this is a shortsighted view. The quote "We could never learn to be brave and patient, if there were only joy in the world" is attributed to Helen Keller, a remarkable woman who overcame blindness and deafness to become a renowned author, activist, and lecturer. She knew firsthand the challenges and hardships that life can bring, but she also appreciated the beauty and meaning that can be found in overcoming them. She believed that joy and sorrow are inseparable, and that they both enrich our lives in different ways. Joy is the natural response to the good things that happen to us, such as love, friendship, success, achievement, pleasure, and satisfaction. Joy gives us a sense of happiness, gratitude, fulfilment, and optimism. It motivates us to pursue our goals and dreams, and to share our gifts and talents with others. Joy is essential for our well-being and happiness. However, joy alone is not enough to make us complete. Joy can blind us to the realities and needs of others, and to the opportunities for improvement and change. We are not perfect. On the other hand, sorrow challenges us to face our problems and difficulties, and to cope with our emotions and feelings. Sorrow is there to make us more resilient. That said, sorrow alone is not enough to make us grow. Sorrow can paralyse us from taking action and moving forward, making us lose sight of our strengths and potentials. Therefore, we need both joy and sorrow in our lives. Joy and sorrow balance each other out, and make us more human.

PASSAGE 96

Being lost at sea is one of the most terrifying experiences a person can face. Imagine being surrounded by nothing but water, with no land in sight, no help on the way,

and no idea how long you will survive. You have to deal with hunger, thirst, exposure, fatigue, and the constant threat of sharks, storms, or pirates. You have to cope with the loneliness, the despair, and the fear of never seeing your loved ones again. You have to hope for a miracle, but also prepare for the worst. Some people who have been lost at sea have managed to survive by using their skills, their resources, and their willpower. They have built rafts, caught fish, collected rainwater, and signalled for rescue. They have prayed, meditated, and kept their spirits up. They have found strength in themselves and in their companions. They have lived to tell their stories. But others have not been so lucky. They have succumbed to dehydration, hypothermia, infection, or injury. They have gone mad, given up, or drowned. They have vanished without a trace, leaving behind only questions and grief. They have become statistics, or legends. Being lost at sea is a test of human endurance and resilience. It is a challenge that few can overcome, and many cannot imagine. It is a nightmare that no one wants to face.

PASSAGE 97

Television enables us to see things in distant places. It is indeed one of the most wonderful things that man has ever invented. Television not only entertains people but also teaches people a variety of important things. Through this wonderful invention, we learn about people and events thousands of miles away. Pictures taken in all parts of the world are also shown on television for entertainment as well as for instruction. Short films based on popular stories, which entertain millions of people all over the world, are often shown. In some countries, television is used to teach pupils and students many useful lessons. Students who cannot go to school because of transport or other problems are taught all their lessons at home through television. As television appeals to the eye instead of the ear, people enjoy watching more than

listening to the radio. Listening requires knowledge of many things, but what we see with our eyes explains that itself. For all these reasons, there is no doubt that television will continue to be popular for a long time.

PASSAGE 98

Up until recently, the British were not exactly keen on cycling. In fact, only a quarter of the twenty million bicycles in the country were thought to be in regular use. Over the last year, though, the number of cyclists in urban areas, particularly in London, has grown by 83 per cent. This has turned the capital into a cleaner, less noisy city compared to many others in Europe. How was this possible? It is all thanks to the National Cycle Network project, which, in the last few years, has managed to encourage many people to use their bicycles either to travel to work or for fun. Moreover, the provision of bicycle parking in the streets, at railway and underground stations, in schools, and in the workplace has contributed significantly to the rise in the number of cyclists. It is estimated that nearly 75 per cent of the population live within two miles of a route, and more cycling trips are made than ever before.

PASSAGE 99

Scientists have dreamed for a long time about building a ‘flying train’ which can float through the air above the tracks. With Maglev technology, their dreams are now a reality. Maglev trains have no wheels. Instead, powerful magnets lift them into the

air and push them forward, at speeds of up to 500 km per hour. As well as speed, Maglev has a number of advantages over other transport systems. The trains are quieter and the journey is smoother because they don't have wheels. They are also greener because they don't use fuel and so create less pollution. Right now, there is only one high-speed Maglev train system in the world. It carries passengers from Shanghai city centre to the airport. However, work has started on a new, longer Maglev track in Japan. Trains will go from Tokyo to Nagoya in 40 minutes. But don't expect to ride on it on your next trip to Japan. It won't open until 2027! Then, in 2045, the line will extend to Osaka. There is one major problem with Maglev technology: it is incredibly expensive to build the tracks. Transport planners predict that the Tokyo to Osaka line will cost 91 billion dollars. The high cost means that Maglev technology probably won't replace other forms of transport in the near future. However, the technology is still in development, and somebody might find a cheaper and simpler way to build the tracks. And then, who knows? In the future, some of us might fly to work by train.

PASSAGE 100

CCTV cameras were initially developed as a means of security for banks. In Britain, they first appeared in 1953 and by the 1960s, there were already a few cameras in major streets in London. Today, there are more than four million CCTV cameras across the country. That's one camera for every fourteen people. The cameras are there to film dangerous or illegal behaviour. With new software, they can automatically recognize the faces of known offenders, and a new kind of CCTV in the Netherlands can detect angry voices and automatically warn the police of trouble. Some CCTV cameras can even interact with the people they are watching. But these cameras don't just watch criminals; they watch all of us, almost all of the time. The

amount of surveillance in towns and cities across Britain is increasing because it is thought to deter crime. Some goods in shops now have RFID tags—radio frequency identification tags—attached to them. When you pick up one of these items, the RFID tag sends a radio message to a CCTV camera and the camera starts filming you. Shops say that this technology helps to catch shoplifters—but only by treating everybody as a potential criminal. Cameras and tags are not the only ways of monitoring our actions. Every time you make or receive a call on your mobile phone, the phone company knows the number of the phone you are calling and how long the call lasts. It is even possible to work out your exact location. The police often use this information when they're investigating serious crimes. Even when you are at home, you are not necessarily safe from surveillance. High-speed internet connections have made computers more vulnerable than ever before. When you use your computer to visit websites, you are probably sending and receiving 'cookies' without realizing it. Cookies transfer information from your computer to the website and, in theory, could record which websites you visit. Modern technology is making it easier and easier to stay in contact, but it is also making it nearly impossible for us to hide.

PASSAGE 101

Reading is a valuable activity that provides numerous benefits to individuals. Firstly, it expands our knowledge. When we read various genres, such as fiction or non-fiction, it increases our understanding. For instance, if you are interested in history, reading historical novels can transport you to different eras and enhance your understanding of past events. Secondly, reading improves our vocabulary. When reading, we encounter new words and phrases that contribute to the richness of our language skills. Furthermore, reading fosters empathy. When we immerse ourselves

in characters' lives and experiences, we can relate to their emotions. We develop a deeper understanding of diverse perspectives, which is crucial for building compassion and understanding in our interactions with others. Books are like passports to distant lands. Through reading, we embark on journeys without traveling physically. We can visit imaginary realms, historical epochs, and futuristic societies, all from the comfort of our reading nooks. In summary, reading is not merely a leisure activity. It is a gateway to knowledge, a linguistic enhancer, a promoter of empathy, and a cultural bridge. It invites us to explore new worlds. It's a voyage that never ends, offering endless opportunities for learning and enrichment.

PASSAGE 102

Tornadoes are giant rotating columns of air. They form in thunderstorms when there is a great difference in the temperature and humidity of the lower and upper atmosphere. They can be very dangerous and very destructive. There are different varieties of tornadoes. They can be very big or small. Some tornadoes are only a few feet across and others can travel across an entire state. Tornadoes stretch from the ground high into the sky. Usually, people rate them from F0 to F5, F5 being the most dangerous with wind speeds of around 261-318 miles per hour. They are a very violent force of nature and can lay whole towns completely flat. Tornadoes can happen all over the world but a lot of them happen in the central United States in a region called Tornado Alley. Tornado Alley is made up of the low, flat states of the central United States between the Rocky Mountains and the Appalachian Mountains. Even though Tornado Alley is the most common place for tornadoes, the deadliest recorded tornado was in Bangladesh in 1989 and killed around 1,300 people. Recently, massive tornadoes destroyed large parts of Alabama in the United States, a state that does not usually have tornadoes.

PASSAGE 103

Many large cities around the world have struggled to keep up with the increase in traffic in recent times. Densely populated areas, growing car ownership, as well as narrow roads built for much lower volumes of traffic all contribute to this. In 1975, Singapore decided to introduce a congestion charge—a fee paid by drivers entering the most traffic-heavy zones of the city. London introduced a congestion charge in 2003. Public opinion was initially opposed to the idea, but people soon became more supportive of the scheme. Despite this, its first decade brought mixed success, and the number of cars in the city fell by only 10%. However, the scheme proved massively profitable, which allowed the city council to invest in other measures aimed at improving traffic conditions in London. These included cycle lanes, pedestrianized areas, and better road surfaces.

PASSAGE 104

Hawaii is often considered to be one place in the world where you can find paradise. But when I arrived in Hawaii, I was shocked to discover beaches were covered in plastic rubbish washed up from around the world. As I dug through the sand, I realised the sandy beach was being transformed into a plastic beach. A chill went down my spine. From the beaches of Hawaii to the seas around Britain, we are

polluting our own environment. Beaches are now covered in more rubbish than ever before. The plastic we see on our beaches is just a small amount of the plastic waste that exists in our oceans. Scientists believe that sea currents have created five huge garbage areas in our oceans, including the one in the North Atlantic. This is a global problem for which we are all responsible. Plastic makes our life easier, but its production and use are completely out of control. Because plastic rubbish in the oceans looks like food, it is being eaten by small fish, which in turn is eaten by large fish, which in turn is eaten by us. Plastic is damaging our beaches, polluting the oceans, and poisoning our food chain. The consequences are still not fully understood, but they are likely to be terrible. We need to stop using plastic bags for packaging and single-use water bottles. These make up most of the plastic garbage in the oceans. In Bangladesh and Kenya, they have stopped using plastic bags completely. The UK has put a tax on plastic bags. Many supermarkets around the world are not packing goods in plastic. The future of our beaches, our seas, and the food chain is at risk. This is an environmental problem that we need to solve immediately.

PASSAGE 105

Education is a cornerstone of personal and societal development, providing individuals with the knowledge, skills, and perspectives necessary to navigate and contribute to the world. It goes beyond the classroom, shaping character, fostering critical thinking, and promoting lifelong learning. Quality education is a powerful tool for breaking the cycle of poverty, empowering individuals, and adding complexity to family and societal relationships. In an interconnected global society, education promotes understanding and tolerance, fostering a more harmonious world. Recognizing the transformative potential of education is essential for building

inclusive, equitable, and prosperous communities that thrive on the principles of knowledge, innovation, and collaboration.

PASSAGE 106

Ever since it was first possible to make a real robot, people have been hoping for the invention of a machine that would do all the necessary jobs around the house. If boring and repetitive factory work could be managed by robots, why not boring and repetitive household chores too? For a long time, the only people who really gave the problem their attention were amateur inventors. And they came up against a major difficulty. That is, housework is actually very complex. It has never been one job, it has always been many. A factory robot carries out one task endlessly until it is reprogrammed to do something else. It doesn't run the whole factory. A housework robot, on the other hand, has to do some different types of cleaning and carrying jobs and also has to cope with all the different shapes and positions of rooms, furniture, ornaments, cats, and dogs. However, there have been some developments recently. Sensors are available to help the robot locate objects and avoid obstacles. We have the technology to produce the hardware. All that is missing is the software—the programs that will operate the machine.

PASSAGE 107

For many years, scientists have been arguing about global warming. While they don't all agree about what this might mean for Planet Earth, many think it is going on—

and that we can do something about it. We need a few more years to gather facts before anyone can say for sure. But people need to start now to do things to stop it. There are many types of gases in our atmosphere. Some of them absorb the heat from the sun and control our climate. "Greenhouse gases" are those that hold the heat around the planet's surface. When we increase the level of these gases, we upset the balance. These extra gases trap even more heat. Some scientists say global warming has already started to change the environment. The Earth's temperature has risen one degree Fahrenheit this century. Many scientists believe it could rise from two to eight degrees Fahrenheit in the next hundred years. This would be the fastest rise in 10,000 years. Sea levels could rise. Ice sheets could melt and add to the water level. Many places near the coast would be in danger of flooding. If the climate change is too large and too fast, some plants and animals could really suffer. They could even die out. Weather could become more violent and extreme. In some places, there would be more forest fires. But in other areas, there would be more rain and snow, storms, and floods.

PASSAGE 108

Over the last several decades, environmental specialists have proposed various strategies aimed at slowing down this process of deforestation in developing countries. Many of these proposals are indeed valuable ideas in that they are realistic attempts to address some of the causes of deforestation, such as farming, cattle ranching, and commercial logging. All of them rely on government involvement of some kind. There are three broad categories of solutions: state economic policies, internal agreements, and international programs. Economic policies generally attempt to limit the activity of small farmers through government action. Government actions can include the clear proper definition and enforcement of property rights,

meaning that squatting, or illegally settling on land, would be more difficult. Subsidies can be used to encourage conservation. That is, money may be paid to supplement the income of those farmers who make an effort to reduce the usual amount of damage to the forest that their farms cause. In addition, taxes can act as a deterrent to undesirable land use. An internal agreement may be made between governments and indigenous or native people living in the moist rainforests and open woodlands of the tropics, where the vast majority of this deforestation is occurring. Such an agreement would allow people to carry on traditional activities adapted for some economic benefit. Finally, international agreements usually involve the exchange of monetary aid in return for government action to protect its forests. One such plan seeks to help pay a nation's debt in exchange for restrictions on certain kinds of activities in rainforests. Instead of selling logging concessions to pay down that obligation, the government receives money for banning or restricting logging in its forests. There is also the proposal of a global fund created in order to grant money to countries that choose to protect their environments. It is clear that something must be done to protect the forests of the world. If the current rate of deforestation continues, the world's rainforests will vanish within 100 years, causing numerous adverse effects on the global climate and eliminating the majority of plant and animal species on the planet.

PASSAGE 109

The difference between higher and further education can be a common cause of confusion. Further education is used to describe the education that occurs following compulsory post-16 secondary education, which is usually distinct from that offered in universities (higher education). It includes a few different levels such as A-Levels and Higher National Diplomas. Foundation Degrees are also a type of further

education and take 2 years to complete compared with the 3-4 years of most bachelor's degrees, which are offered by both universities and colleges. Sometimes it is possible to extend a Foundation Degree to a bachelor's degree, with one year or more of extra study. Further education is usually taught in the sixth-form college part of a school or in independent further education colleges, as well as in other work-based, adult, and community learning institutions. In the United States, further education is sometimes referred to as continuing education. Higher education primarily describes post-18 learning that takes place at universities, as well as other colleges and institutions that award academic degrees and professional qualifications. While higher education is the common name in the UK and Ireland, it is also known as post-secondary, tertiary, and third-level education.

PASSAGE 110

When he was nine years old, Felix Finkbeiner gave a class presentation on climate change. The young German spoke about deforestation and its effect on the planet. At the end of his talk, he challenged the people of his country to help by planting one million trees. Nobody thought much would come of a nine-year-old's study. However, before he was 20, Finkbeiner's efforts had led to the planting of nine million trees in Germany and five billion more around the world. Finkbeiner and his classmates began the initiative, named "Plant-for-the-Planet," by planting a tree outside their school. Other schools followed the example, and news of the one-million-tree challenge spread. As a result, Finkbeiner was invited to speak at the European Parliament. Other invitations soon followed, and when he was 18, just he 13 spoke at a United Nations conference in New York. "We cannot trust that adults alone will save our future," he said in the speech. "We have to take our future in our hands." Finkbeiner is now in his twenties, and Plant-for-the-Planet is an organization

with around 70,000 members. It works to teach people about climate change and to encourage the planting of more trees. Germany's one millionth tree was planted long ago. The goal now is one trillion—150 for every person on Earth.

PASSAGE 111

In the European Union, almost 100 million citizens of all ages invest their time, talents, and money to make a positive contribution to their community by volunteering in civil society organizations, youth clubs, hospitals, schools, sport clubs, and more. For the Commission, volunteering is an active expression of civic participation which strengthens common European values such as solidarity and social cohesion. Volunteering also provides important learning opportunities, because involvement in voluntary activities can lead to new skills and competences that improve employability. This is especially important at this time of crisis. Volunteering plays an important role in sectors as varied as education, youth services, culture, sport, environment, health, social care, consumer protection, humanitarian aid, development policy, research, equal opportunities, and external relations.

PASSAGE 112

All students of the school are hereby informed that Mr. Sanjay Sinha, one of our best teachers, will retire from his service on 6th August 2025. It is a sad day for all of us, as he will no longer come to school to teach mathematics. The student's cultural committee has decided to arrange a farewell meeting to honor him on 6th August

2025 at 4:00 PM in the school assembly hall. All students are requested to participate in this program to show gratitude and honor him for his contributions to all of us. We have also arranged a small cultural program in his honor on that day, so students are requested to submit their names if they wish to take part in this cultural program. Should you need more details, please contact the undersigned.

PASSAGE 113

Culture is the underlying foundation of traditions and beliefs that help a person relate to the world around them. It is the basis for any superstitions they may have. It is the aversion to specific types of meat or which days you can work on. Culture gives us a definite starting point when beginning to search for our roots. Knowing where a person comes from will help to define how they look at their family obligations as well as how they celebrate important milestones in life. As a person gives up their cultural identity, they no longer can identify themselves with the things that were once the most important in their lives. They lose direction. As time passes by and they continue to forget about their past and their natural traditions, their identity becomes less and less pronounced.

PASSAGE 114

People used to know more or less how their children would live. Now things are changing so quickly that they don't even know what their own lives will be like in a few years' time. What follows is not science fiction. It is how experts see the future. You are daydreaming behind the steering wheel; is it too dangerous? No! That's no problem because you have it on automatic pilot, and with its hi-tech computers and

cameras, your car “knows” how to get you home safe and sound. What is for lunch? In the old days, you used to stop off to buy a hamburger or a pizza. Now you use your diagnostic machine to find out which foods your body needs. If your body needs more vegetables and less fat, your food-preparation machine makes you a salad. After lunch, you go down the hall to your home office. Here you have everything you need to do your work. Thanks to your information screen and your latest-generation computer, you needn’t go to the office anymore. The information screen shows an urgent message from a co-worker in Brazil. You can instantly send back a reply to him and go on to deal with other matters.

PASSAGE 115

The Valley Activity Summer Camp offers accommodation, though many students choose to live with local families. We provide excellent exam preparation classes tailored to your special needs. We also offer the best climbing walls in England, and our sports facilities include a pool and tennis courts. Excursions over the weekends are included in the booking fee.

PASSAGE 116

Pollutants are clogging up the atmosphere above our planet and trapping the sun's heat. That makes our planet warmer, which causes glaciers to melt, crazy weather patterns to develop, and natural disasters to spread like wildfires. But there are other consequences that people don't always associate with climate change. One surprising fact about global warming is that it makes people more aggressive. As the world gets hotter, tempers also get fierier. A new study found that violent crimes and even war

become more likely as temperatures rise. Heart rates tend to be elevated in warm weather, so people are prepped for a physical response to a situation. That's not to say we're headed for a violent end as Earth warms up, though. Advances in everything from technology to health have sparked a decline in conflict. It's just that global warming might be slowing that decline. Climate change increases the amount of smog in the air and causes plants to produce more pollen, according to the Natural Resources Defense Council. Those combine to make breathing harder for people, which can be especially tricky for people with asthma and other respiratory illnesses.

PASSAGE 117

Let's have a big round of applause for Jane Doe, who has once again won our Manager of the Year award. Jane's insistence upon remaining a step ahead of managerial trends marks her as an example to us all. In addition to a handsome cash bonus to show our appreciation, Jane will fly first class on all her business travels next year.

PASSAGE 118

Students staying with a host family in another country usually have to make a number of cultural adjustments. They may find it difficult to form friendships with the children in the family and will certainly have to get used to a variety of new things, including food, the climate, and the language. An extra difficulty may be the different expectations which the host parents have of them in comparison with their parents. They may be unprepared for the fact that they are expected to help with the housework or come home earlier in the evenings than they ever would at home. They

may not have as much independence as they are used to, and they may sometimes be surprised by the behavior of the children in the family who, although usually friendly and welcoming, may sometimes seem a little immature. However, language exchange students generally enjoy themselves and often form lasting friendships.

PASSAGE 119

Although your personality may be inherited to some degree, it is clearly also influenced by the people around you. But as you enter your teenage years, who plays the more significant role in this process: your family or your friends? During the early years of your life, you primarily spend your time with your family. Even though your parents take responsibility for shaping your behavior, it is probably your siblings who have the greatest effect. For example, how you interact with your brother or sister while playing games may affect how competitive or conciliatory you become. Similarly, you are more likely to be thick-skinned if you grow up with an insensitive sibling! However, once you enter your teenage years, you spend less time with your family and more time with your friends. Moreover, you start to become more aware of your own personality and how you would like to develop. Consequently, you may choose friends whose personality traits you admire. You may even go so far as to emulate those traits. At the same time, you may start to distance yourself from your family, notwithstanding your close relationship with them, since that is part of growing up and becoming more independent. Although your family remains an important part of your life, it is clear to me that, during your teenage years, your social circle exerts a greater influence. Many aspects of your personality from childhood can survive, but new ones will develop as you make your way towards adulthood with the help of your friends.

PASSAGE 120

Many large cities around the world have struggled to keep up with the increase in traffic in recent times. Densely populated areas, growing car ownership, as well as narrow roads built for much lower volumes of traffic, all contribute to this. In 1975, Singapore decided to introduce a congestion charge—a fee paid by drivers entering the most traffic-heavy zones of the city. London introduced a congestion charge in 2003. Public opinion was initially opposed to the idea, but people soon became more supportive of the scheme. Despite this, its first decade brought mixed success, and the number of cars in the city fell by only 10%. However, the scheme proved massively profitable, which allowed the city council to invest in other measures aimed at improving traffic conditions in London. These included cycle lanes, pedestrianized areas, and better road surfaces.

PASSAGE 121

Man is a unique being. He is different from all other creatures because he does not merely take part in the environment. Man reshapes his environment at will to some purposes.

He does not have a natural habitat and is able to adapt himself to living in different environments. Among the many ways in which Man has changed his environment are the building of cities and roads and the utilization of land for extremely harmful purposes to the environment.

An example of a harmful result of Man's actions is that of pollution. Through the use of scientific knowledge and advanced technology, Man has increased his well-being and life expectancy in the process; however, he has also brought about the growing problem of worldwide pollution.

One of the main sources of air pollution is motor vehicles. Fumes emitted from the

car exhaust contain many chemicals which are harmful to people, animals, and plants.

Industry also contributes significantly to the pollution of the atmosphere. There is no major city in the world today in which we can enjoy clean air.

It is important for us to be environment-conscious and avoid actions which cause harmful effects to our environment.

PASSAGE 122

It can take a long time to become successful in your chosen field, however talented you are.

One thing you have to be aware of is that you will face criticism along the way. The world is full of people who would rather say something negative than positive.

If you've made up your mind to achieve a certain goal, such as writing a novel, don't let the negative criticism of others prevent you from reaching your target, and let the constructive criticism have a positive effect on your work.

If someone says you're totally in the lack of talent, ignore them. That's negative criticism. If, however, someone advises you to revise your work and gives you a good reason for doing so, you should consider their suggestions carefully.

There are many film stars who were once out of work. There are many famous novelists who made a complete mess of their first novel – or who didn't, but had to keep on approaching hundreds of publishers before they could get it published.

Being successful does depend on luck, to a certain extent. But things are more likely to turn out well if you persevere and stay positive.

PASSAGE 123

Finishing high school is a big step opening many doors for young people. There are

various paths to choose from after leaving school, and each one offers unique opportunities.

Some students decide to continue their studies at universities. Universities have many subjects to learn, like science, art, or business.

They offer degrees that can lead to exciting careers. This option allows students to dive deeper into subjects they are passionate about.

For others, vocational training is a great choice. Vocational training focuses on specific skills that are important in jobs like mechanics, cooking, or healthcare.

It gives practical knowledge and prepares students for work right away.

Another option is enrolling in community college. These colleges offer courses that are practical and also give the chance to move to bigger universities later.

They are a good starting point for many students.

Apprenticeships are great for those who like to learn while working. This option gives hands-on experience in fields such as engineering, culinary arts, or information technology.

It not only facilitates the acquisition of comprehensive knowledge and advanced skills but also enables individuals to gain valuable experience and a sustainable income simultaneously.

In recent times, online courses have become very popular. These courses offer flexibility as students can study from home.

They cover a wide range of subjects and give access to education no matter where someone lives.

In conclusion, there are many paths available after finishing school. Each path has its advantages and can lead to a bright future.

It's important for school leavers to explore these options and choose the one that suits them best.

PASSAGE 124

Teaching children to become independent is a gradual and rewarding process. Children should be encouraged to take on small responsibilities at home, such as tidying their rooms or setting the table. However, parents need to balance between offering guidance and allowing them to explore their capabilities themselves.

While providing praise and positive reinforcement can boost their confidence, parents should avoid micromanaging their every move.

Wise parents will adopt a relaxed attitude and take cues from their children.

It is advisable that parents provide gentle guidance, allowing children to learn from their mistakes instead of immediately solving problems for them.

As parents, creating a supportive environment, where children feel comfortable expressing their thoughts and feelings, is indispensable for fostering their emotional well-being.

By nurturing their independence in these small ways, children can develop the skills and confidence needed to navigate life with increasing autonomy.

PASSAGE 125

Reading is an essential skill that enhances our cognitive abilities in many ways.

Firstly, it improves our language skills. When we read, we learn new words and understand how they are used in context, improving our language skills. This helps in expanding our vocabulary and improving our communication skills.

Secondly, reading boosts our imagination and creativity. When we read interesting stories, it takes us to different worlds and situations we might not experience in real life. This stimulates our creativity and helps us think outside the box.

Thirdly, regular reading enhances our concentration and focus. It requires us to pay attention to details and follow complex narratives, keeping our minds sharp.

Additionally, reading provides us with knowledge about various subjects and

cultures. It allows us to gain insights into the lives and experiences of people from diverse backgrounds.

PASSAGE 128

If you are looking forward to gaining some international work experience while making a difference in the lives of the little ones, then probably you should choose to volunteer as an English Teacher in Hanoi.

Kids and teens in Vietnam are still a little weaker when it comes to communicating in English. With the steady growth of tourism and other sectors in the country, it has become necessary for the children to brush up their English speaking skills, in order to keep up with the world. Hence, you'll get to play a major role in the lives of these children, as a volunteer.

You'll be working mostly in schools in the Cau Giay District and other areas around Hanoi. These schools have an extremely poor teacher-student ratio, which often is as low as 70:1, and the teachers are often not well-versed in English. Thus, apart from teaching the students, you can also guide the teachers and boost their confidence.

PASSAGE 129

We are excited to announce we will officially resume in-person classes as of 14. We truly appreciate the outpouring of support over the past several weeks. Our community has come together in so many ways and has exemplified the true meaning of having a black belt mentality.

Because we care for your health and safety, we ask that you take note of some policy updates we've implemented to ensure we are adhering to the highest standard with

physical distancing and sanitization procedures. How you can help keep our building healthy and clean:

- Parents are asked to please drop off and pick up students. This helps us to reduce the group sizes within our facility. We will stream our classes live, so you can watch your children participate in class and be ready for pick up when class wraps up.
- Students should arrive ready to train in their uniforms.
- Everyone should keep moving after classes. We understand you haven't seen your friends in a while, but we must continue to maintain social distancing and also allow the staff time to disinfect.
- You should expect to show up for class no more than 5 minutes ahead of the start time to minimize the number of people in the building.
- We will be checking temperatures using a touch-free Infrared forehead thermometer. Please expect this before you enter the building.

Should you have any questions, please contact us.

PASSAGE 130

Nowadays, media development has many positive influences in human's life. People have lots of sources to get information and take entertainment such as television, radio, Internet, etc., but nobody can deny the importance as well as the benefits of reading books.

First, reading books helps us widen our knowledge. Vietnamese has a proverb which means that we should travel to broaden our understanding; if we always stay at home with our mother, we will never be wise. However, nowadays, not only does reading books cost less money but it is also more comfortable than taking a trip. We just lie on the couch and comprehend what is happening in the books. Thanks to the wide range of books such as science, literature, astronomy, archeology, biology, physics, etc., we can get information focused on our own fields as well as the others. The

more books we have read, the more knowledge we have obtained.

Secondly, reading books helps us improve our expression ability like writing and speaking. The writing style of some of our favorite writers will affect ours. Especially, when we read foreign literature, we will not only know more about that country but also have a chance to improve our reading skill, learn new words which can be used to better our essays.

Last but not least, reading books helps us relax after a hard-working day. It is also an interest for everybody who does not like to visit crowded places at the weekend. They like quiet atmosphere and do not want to disturb anybody. So, they consider books as their close friend. They meet their stories, their lives in books and they feel extremely sympathetic with the characters' situations. Reading books makes them happy and relieve stress.

In conclusion, reading books is so important and has many benefits. It not only helps us become more clever but also brings us happiness. Therefore, everyone should be encouraged to read books as much as possible.

PASSAGE 131

A stinky gym bag in your kitchen? Who will be more upset by the smell - the men or the women in your family? Some scientists suggest that women not only smell, but also feel, taste, and hear more accurately than men.

Take colors, for example. One study suggests that men are not as good as women at distinguishing between shades of color, although they focus well on rapidly changing images. As for touch, small fingers have a finer sense of touch, whether male or female.

Hearing is possibly one of the most debated areas when talking about the senses. Evidence shows that boys hear as well as girls at birth, but with age, a man's hearing may soon deteriorate. However, factors could play a role in this. Women may also

be better at identifying different flavors which need both taste and smell to experience, as studies have shown that they have more taste buds on their tongue. Going back to the smelly gym bag - yes, it's likely that Mom will be the most freaked out by it. But is that because women's brains have more 'smell cells' or because you were too lazy to move it?

PASSAGE 132

I'm a big fan of films featuring the spy James Bond. I've got most of them on DVD. We've recently bought *Quantum of Solace*, in which Daniel Craig plays the part of Bond. I don't know why the film's got that name – but it's a great movie, anyway. All the actors who've played James Bond have been great, but Daniel Craig, who's made lots of other films, plays the part better than any of them. Even though he doesn't talk very much, I think he's the most perfect actor for the role. He even does a few of the more dangerous things in the film himself, instead of getting someone else to do them. I did wonder sometimes whether he'd be clever enough to defeat the bad people – but I'm not going to tell you the ending! The actress who stars with Craig gives a fantastic performance too – I loved all the glamorous clothes she wore. The director probably had a hard job making this Bond film as full of action as earlier ones. But the excitement starts right at the beginning here, with a car chase along a mountain road, and plenty of other thrilling scenes, too – Bond leaping off tall buildings and so on. Unfortunately, I found the story difficult to follow in places, and it also seemed to be over very quickly – it lasted under two hours. I also felt there weren't as many jokes as in the old Bond films. And where was all the ridiculous Bond equipment – the underwater car or exploding watch that everyone laughed at? This is a more serious, darker Bond film, but I still really enjoyed it.

PASSAGE 133

The "greenhouse effect" is the warming that happens when certain gases in Earth's atmosphere trap heat. These gases let in light but keep heat from escaping, like the glass walls of a greenhouse.

First, sunlight shines onto the Earth's surface, where it is absorbed and then radiates back into the atmosphere as heat. In the atmosphere, greenhouse gases trap some of this heat, and the rest escapes into space. The more greenhouse gases are in the atmosphere, the more heat gets trapped.

Scientists have known about the greenhouse effect since 1824, when Joseph Fourier calculated that the Earth would be much colder if it had no atmosphere. This greenhouse effect is what keeps the Earth's climate livable. Without it, the Earth's surface would be an average of about 60 degrees Fahrenheit cooler.

Scientists often use the term "climate change" instead of global warming. This is because as the Earth's average temperature climbs, winds and ocean currents move heat around the globe in ways that can cool some areas, warm others and change the amount of rain and snow. As a result, the climate changes differently in different areas.

PASSAGE 134

When lifestyle changes aren't enough, the next step may be to take medicine. Your health care provider can tell you about special drugs for overactive bladder. There are several drug types that can relax the bladder muscle. These drugs, like anti-muscarinics and beta-3 agonists, can help stop your bladder from squeezing when it's not full. Some are taken as pills, by mouth.

Others are gels or a sticky transdermal patch to give you the drug through your skin. Anti-muscarinics and beta-3 adrenoceptor agonists can relax the bladder muscle and

increase the amount of urine your bladder can hold and empty.

Combination drugs, like using both anti-muscarinics and beta-3 adrenoceptor agonists together, may help control OAB when one option alone isn't working.

Your health care providers will want to know if the medicine works for you. They will check to see if you get relief or if the drug causes problems, known as side effects. Some people get dry mouth and dry eyes, constipation, or blurred vision.

If one drug you try doesn't work, your health care provider may ask you to take different amounts, give you a different one to try, or have you try two types together.

Lifestyle changes and medicine at the same time help many people improve significantly.

PASSAGE 135

Like many emergency responders, Nicholas Groom is used to stress at work.

On one hand, the stress can be helpful.

"I find that when attending a serious incident, it helps me to maintain focus on the situation," Nicholas Groom said.

On the other hand, the work can be highly pressurised.

"Too much stress can impair your ability to make decisions," he adds.

And Groom is not alone in his complicated relationship with stress.

Many people believe that there should be a balanced amount of stress.

In other words, not too much stress so you're not overwhelmed but not too little stress so you don't feel unmotivated.

After all, some anxiety is motivating; think of the adrenaline before a deadline or the excitement before a competition.

Sports fans sometimes even talk about a "gene" in some athletes who seem to play best in the decisive final moments of a match.

Furthermore, many psychologists claim that performance in many situations

increases with stress up to a point.

Of course, any stress can cause harm when it's prolonged.

To take just one example, a long-term high heart rate is linked to cardiovascular diseases.

And additional stressors, such as financial pressures or psychiatric issues, clearly affect how beneficially someone can respond to stress.

PASSAGE 136

Exploring the world of literature offers numerous advantages, especially when it comes to broadening our horizons.

Firstly, it adds an element of enjoyment to learning.

When we delve into literature, whether it's novels, poems, or essays, the immersive experience captivates our interest and makes the learning process more enjoyable.

For instance, reading books in a foreign language can enhance language skills and comprehension.

Secondly, literature expands our cognitive abilities.

Engaging with complex narratives and diverse writing styles challenges our intellect, fostering critical thinking and analytical skills.

Finally, literature serves as a gateway to diverse perspectives, enabling us to understand different cultures, societies, and historical periods.

It's a journey of exploration that goes beyond mere entertainment, enhancing our understanding of the world.

PASSAGE 137

In an educational context, the term 'learner independence' has gained increasing importance in recent years.

It is of particular relevance to language learning and commonly refers to the way students confidently control and organise their own language learning process.

While some people seem to have an almost instinctive flair for languages, others have to rely on strategies to maximise their skills and learn a foreign language more effectively.

The main thing to remember is that becoming a truly independent learner ultimately depends above all on taking responsibility for your own learning and being prepared to take every opportunity available to you to learn.

You also increase your chances of success by learning according to your own needs and interests, using all available resources.

Research shows that learners who adopt this approach will undoubtedly manage to broaden their language abilities considerably and, as a result, are more likely to achieve their objectives in the longer term.

PASSAGE 138

Many universities around the world are proud to have long histories and strong traditions.

However, very few universities can claim to be among the oldest in the world.

Nalanda University, in Bihar, India, was established around 600 BC.

It was most likely the world's first university.

In the past, scholars came from Europe, China, and all over India to learn about science, medicine, the Buddhist religion, and other subjects.

The university is in ruins now, but at one time it was an impressive school with temples, classrooms, libraries, and dormitories.

According to the Guinness Book of World Records, the University of Al-Karaouine in Fes, Morocco, is the oldest surviving university in the world.

It was probably founded in 859 and became a famous place to study natural sciences.

The first university in Europe is definitely the University of Bologna, in Italy. It was one of the few universities in Europe that were not influenced by religion. Professors were forbidden from teaching outside the university, and so students came from all over Europe to study with its famous teachers.

PASSAGE 139

Please be advised of a change to train service.

Starting this April, the North-South express train will no longer be stopping at Green Street Station.

This will affect the express service only; local train service will continue uninterrupted to all stations on the North-South line, including Green Street Station. Please speak with a conductor or visit our Web site should you have any questions. Thank you for your cooperation and for riding Montego Metro.

PASSAGE 140

I am contacting you once again after receiving no reply to my prior e-mail regarding the problem with my gas bill for the month of June.

After receiving my bill for last month, I queried the charge that was included for unpaid gas in May.

When I called your department about the issue, I was informed that the incorrect charges would be removed and that a new bill would be sent to me by e-mail.

However, the new bill still includes these erroneous charges, which I have no intention of paying.

Therefore, I have attached an image of a receipt confirming that I paid my bill for the month of May in full on June 12.

I will send the requested payment at my earliest convenience.

PASSAGE 141

Ever since humans inhabited the earth, they have made use of various forms of communication.

Generally, this expression of thoughts and feelings has been in the form of oral speech.

When there is a language barrier, communication is accomplished through sign language in which motions stand for letters, words, and ideas.

Tourists, the deaf, and the mute have had to resort to this form of expression.

Many of these symbols of whole words are very picturesque and exact and can be used internationally; spelling, however, cannot.

Body language transmits ideas or thoughts by certain actions, either intentionally or unintentionally.

A wink can be a way of flirting or indicating that the party is only joking.

A nod signifies approval, while shaking the head indicates a negative reaction.

Other forms of non-linguistic language can be found in Braille, signal flags, Morse code, and smoke signals.

While verbalization is the most common form of language, other systems and techniques also express human thoughts and feelings.

PASSAGE 142

Pollutants are clogging up the atmosphere above our planet and trapping the sun's heat. That makes our planet warmer, which causes glaciers to melt, crazy weather patterns to develop, and natural disasters spread like wildfires. But there are other consequences that people don't always associate with climate change. One surprising fact about global warming is that it makes people more aggressive.

As the world gets hotter, tempers also get fierier.

A new study found that violent crimes and even war become more likely as temperatures rise. Heart rates tend to be elevated in warm weather, so people are prepped for a physical response to a situation. That's not to say we're headed for a violent end as Earth warms up, though. Advances in everything from technology to health have sparked a decline in conflict.

It's just that global warming might be slowing that decline. Climate change increases the amount of smog in the air and causes plants to produce more pollen, according to the Natural Resources Defense Council. Those combine to make breathing harder for people, which can be especially tricky for people with asthma and other respiratory illnesses.

PASSAGE 143

Music brings many benefits to our lives, especially when we learn something new. Firstly, it makes learning more enjoyable.

When we listen to music while studying, it can help us feel relaxed and happy. This makes it easier to remember what we learn.

For example, if you are learning a new language, listening to songs in that language can help you understand and remember words better.

Secondly, music helps us focus.

When we listen to calm music, our mind becomes less distracted.

We can concentrate better on our tasks, whether it's reading, writing, or solving problems.

This is because music has a special way of grabbing our attention and keeping us engaged.

Finally, music connects us with other cultures.

Through music, we can learn about the traditions, feelings, and stories of people from

different parts of the world.

It's like traveling to new places without leaving our home.

PASSAGE 144

When you're abroad, trying to find out who to tip is never straightforward and neither is trying to work out the exact amount. To make things even more complicated, the rules for tipping vary greatly from country to country. Even people from the same country can't agree on how much to tip. However, here are some general guidelines which might help the traveller.

You face your first dilemma as soon as you land at the airport – the taxi ride. Taxi drivers generally do expect tips, but rather than there being a precise amount, people round up the fare, or just tell the driver to keep the change.

Your next encounter is with the hotel porter and you know he's expecting a tip, but the problem is trying to figure out how much. It seems that in many European countries €3–€5 would be an appropriate amount.

Then, of course, you have to eat. In some countries such as Ireland, Chile, Poland, and Portugal, the customary tip in restaurants is 10–15%, unless a service charge is included, so the first rule of thumb is always check the bill. In other countries such as France, Italy, Germany, Australia, and Spain, where a 10–15% service charge is either very common or compulsory, you may want to leave an additional tip if you think the service was particularly good, but it certainly isn't obligatory. However, in some countries it may seem strange if you do leave a tip. In Iceland, for example, the waitress might be insulted if you tipped her. In Japan, if you left a tip, the restaurant staff wouldn't be offended, but you would probably be pursued down the street by someone trying to return your money. And in New Zealand, although it's unlikely anyone would chase after you, you'd definitely get some odd looks if you left a tip.

And your problem with tipping isn't over when you leave the restaurant. Next you discover the tour guide, the hairdresser, and the toilet attendant are all expecting a tip, but again, how much? Perhaps the best option in these cases is to ask the local people what is acceptable or observe what others do. Of course, you could simply play safe and tip everyone you meet!

PASSAGE 145

According to a new report, living in a city makes it harder for people to concentrate. The research found that people who live in rural areas can focus better than people in urban areas. The study is conducted by Goldsmiths College, which is part of the University of London. Dr Karina Linnell, head researcher, and her team studied how two groups of people did the same tasks. The team went to a remote part of Namibia, southwest Africa, to study the Himba tribe. Himba people live a very basic life in the desert, doing traditional farming. The team also studied members of the same tribe who had moved to the nearest town. Dr Linnell said the people who lived in the desert did much better on the tests than those in the town.

Dr Linnell's research may change the way companies operate. In the future, workers may relocate from cities to live and work in the countryside. Linnell said there are too many things around us in the city that stop us from thinking about one thing for a long time. This means we do not work at our best. She asked: "What if, for example, companies realized certain tasks would be better carried out by employees based outside of the urban environment where their concentration ability is better?" The past century has seen billions of people move from the countryside to big cities. If Dr Linnell's research is true, this century might see many of those people return to the great outdoors.

PASSAGE 146

When I tell people about the idea of moving out, many people's reaction is like "what do your parents say?" because they assume parents would not like their children to leave them. I don't know if my parents like it, but they always support and respect my decisions. They think it is good for me to try and live on my own and then I would know it is best to stay with my family. The most important reason for independent living is to save the travelling time to work. It used to take me one hour fifteen minutes to travel to work from my previous living place.

From my new apartment, it just takes me thirty minutes, so I saved forty-five minutes travelling time. I don't have to get up early, and I save two thirds of my traveling cost. In addition, I gain my personal space and freedom by independent living. I make my own decisions; I don't have to say whether I would go home for dinner; I can invite my friends to come and stay late.

Money is the main issue in living on your own. You must be responsible for all the expenses. Therefore, you've got to be well prepared and save up for your bills. Although I find my transportation time much shorter, the saved time is spent on other things, such as cooking and other household chores. Preparing and cooking the food do occupy a significant portion of my time, therefore I always try to make simple meals. Moreover, I have to regularly tidy up my apartment and wash my clothes, so it doesn't really save much of my time.

Now I'm getting used to my new life, and I'm enjoying it. I feel that moving out makes it easier for me to strike a balance between my work, my social life, my study and my family. It may be troublesome, but it may be worth it.

PASSAGE 147

Have you ever wondered what it would be like to get your dream job? It can take years to get the education and develop the skills you need for the perfect job. However, there is a way to experience your dream job without having to get the required training or degree.

Since 2004, Brian Kurth's company, Vocation Vacations, has been connecting people with mentors who have the jobs of their dreams. Kurth had been working for a phone company before starting his own company. He didn't like his job, and he had a long time to think about it on his drive to and from work. He also thought about his dream job while driving. He was interested in becoming a dog trainer, but he didn't want to take any chances and switch to a field he didn't have experience in.

He really wanted to know what the job was like and if it was realistic for him to work towards his goal. So he found a mentor - a dog trainer that could tell him about the job and everything it involved. After that, he helped his friends find mentors to explore jobs they were interested in. They thought it was helpful to talk to people who had their dream jobs before spending lots of time and money getting the training they needed for those jobs.

Kurth saw how much this helped his friends, so he decided to turn it into a business. He started Vocation Vacations in 2004, and by 2005, the company was offering experiences with over 200 dream jobs. Today, about 300 mentors work with the company to share their knowledge about their jobs. Customers pay to experience the job of their dreams and work with these mentors to see what a job is really like. A "job vacation" costs between \$350 and \$3,000 and can be for one to three days.

Many people use Vocation Vacations to see if their dream job is a career path they want to continue. Others do it just to experience the job of their dreams one time. Vocation Vacations jobs are in the fields of fashion, food, entertainment, sports, and animals. Many people want to try glamorous jobs. For example, they want to try working as actors, music producers, photographers, and fashion designers.

According to Kurth, some other popular dream jobs are working as bakers, hotel managers, and wedding planners.

PASSAGE 148

Plastic is a material we use every day. The first plastics were made more than 100 years ago from parts of plants. Plastics are now made from oil, coal, and natural gas. We are using up these things so fast that the Earth's supplies may run out. Because of this, scientists are investigating new ideas for making plastics from plants such as sweet potato, bamboo, and flax.

Things made from plastic can be useful for people but bad for the environment. Some plastics can last for a long time without wearing out, and can be difficult to get rid of when not needed. They can remain in rubbish dumps called landfill sites for hundreds of years. Landfills can be smelly, ugly, and harmful to our planet.

Recycling is a good way to get rid of unwanted plastics. Recycled waste materials can be used again to make new products. This can be difficult as different types of plastic need to be recycled in different ways. Some kinds of plastics can be melted down and used to make new things such as bags and bottles. Others can be made into fibres for clothing.

Another way to protect the environment is to use canvas bags for shopping rather than plastic ones. A lot of plastic objects can also be reused. Plastic bottles can be refilled many times, rather than throwing them away once they are empty. Unwanted plastic goods such as CDs and toys can be sold or given away to charity shops.

PASSAGE 149

"A healthy mind lives in a healthy body" is a saying which is believed to have often

been used by the ancient Greeks. Thousands of years later, the same idea still applies. According to health experts, it's advisable to drink eight to ten glasses of water every day. However, water itself is not enough; a balanced diet is essential.

A healthy body naturally is the result of doing exercise. Many people, however, do not like gyms and object to going there for different reasons. Some, for instance, say that aerobic sessions are too difficult to follow, while others say that gyms are just too expensive.

Many people also say that they have difficulty in finding time to exercise due to their busy lifestyle, but the truth is everyone can make a little time every now and then.

Regardless of the way people choose to exercise, it is important to remember that there's no point in doing it only for a short period of time.

Last but not least, having a positive attitude and doing away with negative thoughts contributes to good health.

In short, following this simple advice surely helps in having a healthy mind and body.

PASSAGE 150

When naming a child, some parents seem to choose a name based simply on their personal preference. In other families, grandparents or professional name-makers come up with a child's name. And in some cases, the time of a child's birth influences how the child's name is determined.

In many European cultures, names are typically chosen by parents. Parents' choice for their child's name may be based on names of relatives or ancestors within their particular family.

For example, in Italy, children are traditionally named after their grandparents. The parents generally use the father's parents' names first. If they have more children, then they will use the mother's parents' names. Similarly, some people in Eastern Europe name their children after relatives who have died. This tradition is seen as a

means to protect the child from the Angel of Death.

Traditionally in some Asian countries, a child's grandfather or a fortune-teller chooses the child's name. In contrast to the tradition of naming children after relatives, the child's name is chosen to influence the child's character. For example, names may be based on a connection to certain elements such as fire, water, earth, wood, or metal. Or the name might include a written character meaning beauty, strength, or kindness.

In certain African cultures, when a child is born plays a large part in determining the child's name. In Ghana's Akan culture, the day a child is born determines the child's name.

But each day has different names for boys and girls. For instance, a boy born on Friday is named Kofi, whereas a girl born on the same day is named Afua. Both Kofi and Afua are names meaning "wanderer" or "explorer." Children with these names are seen as travelers.

No matter where the name comes from, a child's name is the first gift in life. Whether it is chosen according to preference or dictated by tradition, the name reflects something about a child's culture. For that reason, all names should be treasured and respected.

PASSAGE 151

Nowadays, more and more teenagers are getting involved in community activities. Some may join different charity groups to help the needy in their neighbourhoods or other areas.

Others may set up volunteer clubs at their schools and develop their own plans to help people in the community.

These may include various community activities, such as donating old clothes, cleaning up the environment, and organising after-school activities for children.

When teenagers take part in community activities, they gain numerous benefits. First, they come into contact with other teenagers who share similar interests. Secondly, teenagers can learn and improve their life skills. Thirdly, community activities can increase teenagers' self-confidence and boost their well-being. Finally, doing volunteer work in the community is the perfect opportunity for teenagers to gain essential leadership experience that all employers want to see.

PASSAGE 152

Today, we hear more and more about the importance of getting enough sleep. Sleep can give energy to both our bodies and our brains. It can also affect our feelings, behaviour, and memory.

Studies have shown that people in some countries spend less time sleeping and more time working. But our bodies cannot work well without enough sleep. Losing just one or two hours of sleep a night, over a long period of time, can badly affect our health. We cannot work for many hours; we can get angry easily; and we can even lose our IQ points. That explains why, without enough sleep, an intelligent person may have difficulty doing daily tasks.

Studies have also shown that the time of year seems to affect how much sleep we need. People usually sleep longer in the winter, sometimes as much as 14 hours a night. However, in the summer, they sometimes sleep as little as six hours, without having any problems.

PASSAGE 153

Many scientists believe our love of sugar may be an addiction. When we eat or drink sugary foods, the sugar enters our blood and affects parts of our brain. This makes

us feel good. Then the good feeling goes away, leaving us wanting more. All tasty foods do this, but sugar has a stronger effect.

In this way, it is in fact an addictive drug, one that doctors recommend we all cut down on. "It seems like every time I study an illness and trace a path to the first cause, I find my way back to sugar," says scientist Richard Johnson. One-third of adults worldwide have high blood pressure, and up to 347 million have diabetes.

Why? "Sugar, we believe, is one of the culprits, if not the major culprit," says Johnson. So what is the solution? It's obvious that we need to eat less sugar. Many schools are replacing sugary desserts with healthier options like fruit. Other schools are growing their own foods in gardens, or building facilities, like walking tracks so students and others in the community can exercise.